

Chapter 1

. The Mystical Way The Way that can be described is not the absolute Way; the name that can be given is not the absolute name. Nameless it is the source of heaven and earth; named it is the mother of all things.		The Ineffable, about which is spoken, is not the eternal Ineffable A name for the Unnameable, is but a name The Unnameable is what makes everything what it is By naming things you divide the Indivisible Only one who gives up all his desires can		The Tao that can be defined is not the real Tao. The name that can be named is not the real Name. The unnamable [Tao] is the source of Heaven and Earth. Naming is the mother of all particular things.
Whoever is desireless, sees the essence of life. Whoever desires, sees its manifestations. These two are the same, but what is produced has names. They both may be called the cosmic mystery: from the cosmic to the mystical is the door to the essence of all life. up		experience the Indivisible One who still cherishes desires, will experience only dissension Both will see the same reality, but experience it differently One who goes from the false reality into the other, Will pass through the narrow gate and receive the secret of true life up		Free from desire, you experience reality. Trapped in desire, you see only appearances. Reality and appearance have different names, but they emerge from the same source [i.e., the Tao]. This source is called darkness, deep darkness; and yet it is the way to all wisdom. up

Chapter 2

When people think
`this´ is beautiful,
they must think
`that´ is ugly When
people say `this´ is
good, than they
have to say `that´
is evil This is
Inevitable People
create a false
reality out of the
real one Hard and
easy are relative
Long and short
depend upon each
other High and low
are determined

No beauty without
ugliness. No good
without evil. Being
and non-being
are two aspects of
the same reality.
Difficult and easy,
long and short,
high and low,
before and after:
With each pair,
two sides of the
same coin..
Therefore, the
Tao Master acts
with non-do
[wuwei] and
teaches without
speaking.

Therefore the wise
manage affairs
without interfering
and teach beyond
the words. All
things rise, and
they do not turn
away from them.
They give them
life, but do not take
possession of
them. They act,
but do not rely on
their own ability.
They accomplish,
but claim no credit.
Because they
claim no credit,
their
accomplishment
remains with them.
up

by a position
Sound and voice
need one another
Before and beyond
assume a point of
view That's why a
wise man acts
without intentions
And won't decide
for others what to
do He'll let
anything happen
as it happens He
won't consider
what he does as
his own merit And
only therein is he
praiseworthy up

By the use of this
method, the sage
can fulfil his will
without action, and
utter his word
without speech. All
things arise
without diffidence;
they grow, and
none interferes;
they change
according to their
natural order,
without lust of
result. The work is
accomplished; yet
continueth in its
orbit, without goal.
This work is done
unconsciously; this
is why its energy is
indefatigable.

Things come and
go. He lets them
come and go. He
creates, but he
does not own. He
achieves, but he
takes no credit. He
completes his
work and then
forgets about it.
Practice non-do,
and your
accomplishments
endure. up

Chapter 3

. Simplicity Do not exalt the worthy, so that people will not compete. Do not value rare treasure, so that people will not steal. Do not display objects of desire, so that people's hearts will not be disturbed.		When you praise people for their achievements, people will compete When you call things valuable, people will steal When people flaunt desirable things, it will make other people restless Therefore the sage sets himself to the task of emptying their heads To make	QUIETING FOLK To reward merit is to stir up emulation; to prize rarities is to encourage robbery; to display desirable things is to excite the disorder of covetousness. Therefore, the sage governeth men by keeping their minds and their bodies at rest, contenting the one by emptiness, the other by fullness.	Glorify the superior, hatch jealousy and competition. Value possessions, provoke stealing. Stimulate desire, enflame the passions. Therefore, the Taoist Master would rule by emptying minds and filling bellies, by weakening desire and strengthening bodies.
Therefore the wise lead by keeping their hearts pure, their bellies full, their ambitions weak, and their bones strong, so that the people may be purified of their thoughts and desires; and the cunning ones will not interfere. By acting without interfering, all may live in peace. up		sure they're not hungry, discourage their ambitions and strengthen their bodies So people will be without anxiety and without the desire for knowledge And the scientists will be played off the field When people won't labour anymore All will live in peace up	He satisfieth their desires, thus fulfilling their wills, and making them frictionless; and he maketh them strong in body, to a similar end. He delivereth them from the restlessness of knowledge and the cravings of discontent. As to those who have knowledge already, he teacheth them the way of non-action. This being assured, there is no disorder in the world.	He would lead the people away from knowing and wanting and would try to prevent those with knowledge from interfering. Practice non-action, and everything will fall into place. up

Chapter 4

. The Infinite Way The Way is infinite; its use is never exhausted. It is bottomless, like the fountainhead of all things. It smoothes its roughness; it unties its tangles.

Nature contains nothing but natures; and these natures are nothing over and above Nature. In Nature, all natures originate, all conflicts are settled, all differences are united, all disturbances are quieted.

That which maintains the Creation Is like an empty barrel that's inexhaustible It is like a fathomless emptiness, filling the whole Creation Its sharpness brings about curves Its angles dissolve It dims its light

THE SPRING WITHOUT SOURCE The Tao resembleth the emptiness of Space; to employ it, we must avoid creating ganglia. Oh Tao, how vast art Thou, the Abyss of Abysses, thou Holy and Secret Father of all Fatherhoods of Things!

The Tao is empty: used but never used up. It is the bottomless source of all things. It blunts sharp edges, unties knots, softens glare, clears dust.

It softens its light; it calms its turmoil. Deep and still, ever present. I do not know its source. It seems to have existed before the Lord. up

Yet no matter how many natures come into being, they can never exhaust Nature. To look for an external source of Nature is foolish, for Nature is the source of all else. up

It restrains its touch How pure and calm it stays, like deep waters I don't know its origin It seems like it is even older than that by which it is brought forth up

Let us make our sharpness blunt; let us loosen our complexes; let us tone down our brightness to the general obscurity. Oh Tao, how still art thou, how pure, continuous One beyond Heaven! This Tao hath no Father; it is beyond all other conceptions, higher than the highest.

It is hidden, but always present. I don't know its mother. It is older than the gods [if there are any gods]. up

Chapter 5

. Emptiness and the Center Nature is not humane. It treats all things like sacrificial objects. The wise are not humane. They regard people like sacrificial objects. How the universe is like a bellows!	Opposites are not sympathetic to each other. Each one of the many kinds of opposites acts as if it could get along without its other. But Nature treats opposites impartially, dealing with each of every pair of opposites with the same indifference. And the intelligent man will regard opposites in the same manner. No matter how deeply natures are torn by opposition, Nature itself remains unchanged.	The Creation does not pretend to be friendly It treats all things impartially One who is wise doesn't act friendly All people are equal to him The Universe is like bellows Although	THE FORMULA OF THE VACUUM Heaven and earth proceed without motive, but casually in their order of nature, dealing with all things carelessly, like used talismans. So also the sages deal with their people, not exercising benevolence, but allowing the nature of all to move without friction.	The Tao is impartial; it sees all things as straw [fake] dogs. The Tao■Master is also impartial; he regards people as straw dogs.
While empty, it is never exhausted. The more it is worked, the more it produces. Much talk brings exhaustion. It is better to keep to the center. up		empty, it fills continuously The harder it works, the more it brings forth The more you talk about it, the wearier you get Therefore, you'd better stick to what really matters up	The Space between heaven and earth is their breathing apparatus: Exhalation is not exhaustion, but the complement of Inhalation, and this equally of that. Speech exhausteth; guard thyself, therefore, maintaining the perfect freedom of thy nature.	The Tao is like a bellows: it is empty yet infinitely available. It is always producing. Speak of it, fail to grasp it. Hold on to the center. up

Chapter 6

. The Mystical Female The spirit of the valley never dies. It is called the mystical female.	The tendency towards opposition is ever-present. Opposition is the source of all growth. And the principle of opposition is the source of all opposites.	The spirit of depth never dies People sometimes call it the Great Mother The gate through which she breathes	THE PERFECTING OF FORM The Teh is the immortal enemy of the Tao, its feminine aspect.	The valley spirit, the Great Mother: Her doorway is the channel from which Heaven and Earth came forth.
The door of the mystical female is the root of heaven and earth. It seems to be continuously within us. Use it, and it will never fail. up	The principle of opposition is inherent in Nature, so oppositeness will continue forever, no matter how many opposites may come and go. up	Is the foundation of Creation It appears to be everlasting When you rely on that, life will be effortless up	Heaven and Earth issued from her Gate; this Gate is the Root of their World-Sycamore. Its operation is of pure Joy and Love, and faileth never.	She is always present and inexhaustible. up

Chapter 7

. Enduring Heaven is eternal, and the earth is very old. They can be eternal and long lasting, because they do not exist for themselves, and for this reason can long endure.	The principle of initiation persists; and the principle of completion continues. Why do such opposing principles persist? Because they inhere in Nature, rather than stand by themselves. That is why opposites endure.	The Universe is everlasting The reason why it is everlasting Is because it doesn't exist for itself Therefore it can last Therefore a wise man behaves as the least And because he is least, he is the greatest He is detached and therefore he is safe Couldn't it be possible that he is perfect, Just because he is disinterested?	THE CONCEALMENT OF THE LIGHT Heaven and Earth are mighty in continuance, because their work is delivered from the lust of result.	Heaven and Earth are everlasting. Since they were never born, they will never die. They do not exist for themselves and thus go on forever.
Therefore the wise put themselves last, but find themselves foremost. They are indifferent to themselves, and yet they always remain. Is it not because they do not live for themselves that they find themselves fulfilled? up	The intelligent man, when an issue arises, stands off and observes both contentions. Since he does not take sides, he never loses a battle. By not favouring one side more than the other, he is able to appreciate the virtues of both sides. up	up	Thus also the sage, seeking not any goal, attaineth all things; he doth not interfere in the affairs of his body, and so that body acteth without friction. It is because he meddleth not with personal aims that these come to pass with simplicity.	The Tao■Master stays behind and is thus ahead. He is detached and is thus one with all things. He is selfless and is thus fulfilled. up

Chapter 8

The best way to conduct oneself may be observed in the behaviour of water. Water is useful to every living thing, yet it does not demand pay in return for its services; it does not even require that it be recognized, esteemed, or appreciated for its benefits. This illustrates how intelligent behaviour so closely approximates the behaviour of Nature itself.

A perfect human being is like the water That benefits all things and competes with nothing It stays in places which others despise But in this way it follows its origin In his heart the wise cherishes simplicity In contact with others

THE NATURE OF PEACE Admire thou the High Way of Water! Is not Water the soul of the life of things, whereby they change? Yet it seeketh its level, and abideth content in obscurity. So also it resembleth the Tao, in this Way thereof!

It is good to be like water. It nourishes without effort. It flows without contention into low places that people scorn. Thus, it is like the Tao. In dwelling, live close to the land.

he is amiable In his words he is reliable In his leading he is peaceful In what he does he is competent He does everything at the moment it needs to be done He won't fight And therefore he is impeccable up

The virtue of a house is to be well-placed; of the mind, to be at ease in silence as of Space; of societies, to be well-disposed; of governments, to maintain quietude; of work, to be skillfully performed; and of all motion, to be made at the right time. Also it is the virtue of a man to abide in his place without discontent; thus offendeth he no man.

In thinking, go deep. In relating to others, be gentle. In governing, seek good order and justice. In acting, be skillful. In working, do all things at the right time. No contention, no strife. up

Chapter 9

Going to extremes is never best. For if you make a blade too sharp, it will become dull too quickly. And if you hoard all the wealth, you are bound to be attacked.

It is better to carry an empty barrel than a full one. Sharpen a knife until it is razor-sharp and it won't last long. When a house is filled with valuables, it

THE WAY OF RETICENCE Fill not a vessel, lest it spill in carrying. Meddle not with a sharpened point by feeling it constantly, or it will soon become blunted. Gold and jade endanger the house of their possessor.

Fill your bowl all the way: it overflows. Keep sharpening your sword: it gets dull. Pile up gold and jade: it cannot be protected.

If you become proud and arrogant regarding your good fortune, you will naturally beget enemies who jealously despise you. The way to success is this: having achieved your goal, be satisfied not to go further. For this is the way Nature operates. up

is impossible to guard. When wealth and ambition make one arrogant, it will lead to a fall. When fame and success menace you, pull back. That's the only road to true bliss. up

Wealth and honors lead to arrogance and envy, and bring ruin. Is thy way famous and thy name becoming distinguished? Withdraw, thy work once done, into obscurity; this is the way of Heaven.

Increase your wealth, status, and power: you suffer ruin. Do your work, then withdraw: that's the Way! up

Chapter 10

		Can you empty your head and lastingly lose yourself in Creation? Can you live up to your nature and become like a child? Can you purify the doors of perception and see clearly again? Can you love your fellow man and serve mankind disinterestedly? Can you go in and out of the narrow gate without any effort?	THINGS ATTAINABLE When soul and body are in the bond of love, they can be kept together. By concentration on the breath it is brought to perfect elasticity, and one becomes as a babe. By purifying oneself from Samadhi one becomes whole. In his dealing with individuals and with society, let him move without lust of result.	Can you keep body and soul together and find your wholeness in the One? Can you make your breathing as soft as a newborn child's? Can you cleanse your inner vision until you see with perfect clarity? Can you love the people and govern the country without ado?
--	--	--	--	--

		Can you be in the world without being possessed by it? Can you realize that you can't know anything and therefore understand everything? Nature brings forth everything and feeds everything. She brings forth but possesses nothing. She does everything disinterestedly and asks for nothing. She leads but demands nothing. That is what people call the incomprehensibility of Nature up	In the management of his breath, let him be like the mother-bird. Let his intelligence comprehend every quarter; but let his knowledge cease. Here is the Mystery of Virtue. It createth all and nourisheth all; yet it doth not adhere to them; it operateth all, but knoweth not of it, nor proclaimeth it; it directeth all, but without conscious control.	Can you, like a woman, open and close the gates of Heaven? Can you understand all things and take no action? Giving birth and nourishing, having but not owning, acting without seeking praise, leading but not dominating: this is the highest virtue [Te]. up
--	--	---	---	--

Chapter 11

. Use What Does Not Exist Thirty spokes are united around the hub of a wheel, but the usefulness of the wheel depends on the space where nothing exists. Clay is molded into a vessel, but the usefulness of the vessel depends on the space where nothing exists.		Thirty spokes unite within the nave But the wheel is only useful because of the cavity inside the nave Clay is kneaded into vases But the utility is determined by the cavity When building a	THE VALUE OF THE UNEXPRESSED The thirty spokes join in their nave, that is one; yet the wheel dependeth for use upon the hollow place for the axle.	Thirty spokes are joined in the hub of the wheel, but it is the center hole, where it is empty, that makes the wheel useful. We make a clay pot, but it is the emptiness inside that makes the pot useful.
Doors and windows are cut out of the walls of a house, and the usefulness of the house depends on the space where nothing exists. Therefore take advantage of what exists, and use what does not exist. up	In order to build a house, although we must establish solid walls, we must also provide doors and windows; so both the impenetrable and penetrable are essential to a useful building. Therefore, we profit equally by the positive and negative ingredients in each situation. up	house they leave blank spots in the walls for doors and windows But the utility of the house depends on the cavity inside Therefore, that which exists is useful But the cavity makes it possible up	Clay is shapen to make vessels; but the contained space is what is useful. Matter is therefore of use only to mark the limits of the space which is the thing of real value.	We cut windows and doors to make a room, but it is the inner emptiness that makes the room useful. We seek to take advantage of what is, but we also find much use for what is not. up

Chapter 12

. Satisfy the Inner Self The five colors blind the eyes; the five musical tones deafen the ears; the five flavors dull the taste. Racing and hunting madden the mind.

Interest in the varieties of colour diverts the eye from regarding the thing which is coloured. Attention to the differences between sounds distracts the ear from consideration for the source of the sounds. Desire for enjoyment of the various flavours misdirects the appetite from seeking foods which are truly nourishing.

All those artificial colours blind people's eyes All that man-made music deafens people's ears All those various flavours dull our taste Horse races and hunting drive people crazy The desire for scarce goods

THE WITHDRAWAL FROM THE EXTERNAL The five colors film over Sight; The five sounds make Hearing dull; The five flavours conceal Taste; occupation with motion and action bedevil Mind; even so the esteem of rare things begetteth covetousness and disorder.

The five colors can make us blind. The five sounds can make us deaf. The five flavors can deaden our taste. Racing, chasing, and hunting can drive us mad.

Precious goods keep their owners on guard. Therefore the wise satisfy the inner self rather than external senses. They accept the one and reject the other. up

Excessive devotion to chasing about and pursuing things agitates the mind with insane excitement. Greed for riches ensnares one's efforts to pursue his healthier motives. The intelligent man is concerned about his genuine needs and avoids being confused by dazzling appearances. He wisely distinguishes one from the other. up

Hinders people from going on the straight and simple path Therefore the wise finds his satisfaction In feeding himself and then he won't exhaust his eyes Therefore he does this and leaves that up

The wise man seeketh therefore to content the actual needs of the people; not to excite them by the sight of luxuries. He banneth these, and concentrateth on those.

The pursuit of treasure knocks us off the path. Therefore, the Tao■Master follows his inner vision rather than his outer vision. He chooses this but not that. up

Chapter 13

. Selflessness Good fortune and misfortune cause apprehension. Regard great trouble as you regard your self. What is meant by "Good fortune and misfortune cause apprehension?" Those with good fortune are apprehensive of their gain. Those with misfortune are apprehensive of their loss.			THE CONTEMPT FOR CIRCUMSTANCE Favor and disgrace are equally to be shunned; honour and calamity to be alike regarded as adhering to the personality. What is this which is written concerning favour and disgrace? Disgrace is the fall from favour. He then that hath favour hath fear, and its loss begetteth fear yet greater of a further fall.	Being in favor or being in disgrace: either way, trouble. It is all within the Self. What does this mean? Being in favor, we fear falling out of favor. Being out of favor, we fear remaining there.
What is meant by "Regard great trouble as you regard your self?" Great trouble comes from being selfish. Being selfless, what trouble is there? Therefore those who value the world as themselves may be entrusted to govern the world. Those who love the world as themselves may be entrusted to care for the world. up		Disasters come over us because we've got something to lose If we had nothing to lose, which disasters could still strike us? Therefore: to him who considers himself just as worthy as the world, Mankind can entrust the world And to him who loves himself and the world just as unconditionally, Mankind can entrust the care for the world up	What is this which is written concerning honour and calamity? It is this attachment to the body which maketh calamity possible; for were one bodiless, what evil could befall him? Therefore let him that regardeth himself rightly administer also a kingdom; and let him govern it who loveth it as another man loveth himself.	This fear is within the Self. No Self, no fear. Do you value the world as you value yourself? You may be trusted to rule. Do you love the world as you love yourself? The world may be entrusted to your care. up

Chapter 14

. The Formless Way We look at it, and do not see it; it is invisible. We listen to it, and do not hear it; it is inaudible. We touch it, and do not feel it; it is intangible. These three elude our inquiries, and hence merge into one. Not by its rising, is it bright, nor by its sinking, is it dark.

We look at it but we do not see it and we call it the invisible We listen to it but don't hear it and we call it the inaudible We grope at it but never touch it and we call it the untouchable The invisible, the inaudible and the untouchable come together in one There is no light when it rises There is no darkness when it descends Continuously, constantly,

Look, but you can't see it. Listen, but you can't hear it. Reach out, but you can't touch it. Invisible, inaudible, intangible. Elusive. The One. When it rises, no light. When it sets, no darkness.

Infinite and eternal, it cannot be defined. It returns to nothingness. This is the form of the formless, being in non-being. It is nebulous and elusive. Meet it, and you do not see its beginning. Follow it, and you do not see its end. Stay with the ancient Way in order to master what is present. Knowing the primeval beginning is the essence of the Way. up

but it cannot be put into words And it returns to nothing This is what they call the form of the formless, the image of the invisible People call it indefinite and impalpable You won't see it from the front You won't see it from behind One who lives after their original conscience, lives in the present And understands everything that has ever been That is living according to nature up

It calls all things back into nothingness [No ■Thing■Ness]. Formless form, imageless image. No front, no back. Live in the Tao of old, master the present. Know the Source: The essence of Tao. up

Chapter 15

--	--	--	--	--

Who can make sense of a muddy world? Let it be still, and it becomes clear. Who can remain calm, and through activity come back to life? Those who embrace this Way do not over-extend themselves. Because they do not over-extend themselves, they do not wear out and are not replaced. up		Stagnation will settle the mud down and the water will become clear Let everything happen as it happens and you will come to rest The head of the wise is empty, he does not search for anything and expects nothing He is empty, everlasting, youthful and not caught in time He is perfect up	Who can clear muddy water? Stillness will accomplish this. Who can obtain rest? Let motion continue equably, and it will itself be peace. The adepts of the Tao, conserving its way, seek not to be actively self-conscious. By their emptiness of Self they have no need to show their youth and perfection; to appear old and imperfect is their privilege.	We must wait for the water to settle; then it will be clear. Can you keep still until what is needed becomes clear? Those who follow the Tao are not full of themselves. They are like durable garments that need no renewal. up
---	--	--	--	---

Chapter 16

. Know the Eternal Empty yourself of everything. Maintain a steady serenity. All things take shape and become active, but I see them return to their source, like vegetation that grows and flourishes, but returns to the root from which it springs. Returning to the source is serenity; it is to realize one's destiny. To realize one's destiny is to know the eternal. To know the eternal is to be enlightened.		One who has an empty head is satisfied, One who is satisfied has an empty head All creatures exert and come to rest All plants grow to maturity and come to rest That final rest is what's called being done; completion Returning to nature is what's called eternal life Living in the present is called being enlightened One who is	THE WITHDRAWAL TO THE ROOT Emptiness must be perfect, and Silence made absolute with tireless strength. All things pass through the period of action; then they return to repose. They grow, bud, blossom and fruit; then they return to the root. This return to the root is this state which we name Silence; and this Silence is Witness of their Fulfilment. This cycle is the universal law.	Empty yourself. Be calm. The ten thousand things come and go. Just watch them. All things return to the Source, where there is stillness. To return to the Source is to recover what is permanent. Knowing what is permanent: enlightenment. Not knowing what is permanent: disaster.
Not to know the eternal is to act blindly and court disaster. Whoever knows the eternal is open to everything. Whoever is open to everything is impartial. To be impartial is to be universal. To be universal is to be in accord with heaven. To be in accord with heaven is to be in accord with the Way. To be in accord with the Way is to be eternal and to live free from harm even though the body dies. up		not enlightened lives in confusion and misery One who lives according to his nature understands everything and is forbearing One who is forbearing is righteous One who is righteous is royal One who is royal is divine One who is divine knows oneself One who knows oneself has eternal life One who has eternal life is not afraid to die up		Knowing what is permanent opens the mind. Open mind, open heart. Open heart, magnanimity. Magnanimity, a virtue of queens and kings. A true queen or king lives in accord with Nature. To live in accord with Nature is to find the Tao. Following the Tao makes death harmless. up

Chapter 17

. Leaders The best leaders the people barely know. The next best they love and praise. The next they fear. And the next they hate.

The most intelligent leaders bring about results without making those controlled realize that they are being influenced. The less intelligent seek to motivate others by appeals to loyalty, honour, self-interest, and flattery. Those still less intelligent employ fear by making their followers think they will not receive their rewards. The worst try to force others to improve by condemning their conduct.

Of the wise of old, people only knew that they existed Later on they loved them and admired them Thereafter they got scared of them And finally the wise were seen as despicable

THE PURITY OF THE CURRENT In the Age of Gold, the people were not conscious of their rulers; in the Age of Silver, they loved them, with songs; in the Age of Brass, they feared them; in the Age of Iron, they despised them.

The best ruler: hardly known to exist. Next best: known and loved. Next best: feared. The worst: despised.

Those who lack trust will not be trusted. Then they resort to promises. But when they accomplish their task and complete their work, the people say, "We did it ourselves." up

But since, if leaders do not trust their followers then their followers will not trust the leaders, The intelligent leader will be careful not to speak as if he doubted or distrusted his follower's ability to do the job suitably. When the work is done, and as he wanted it done, he will be happy if the followers say: "This is just the way we wanted it." up

One who can't trust oneself, can't trust another How cautious were the first with their words They proceeded so cautiously that when they where done The people thought they did it themselves up

As the rulers lost confidence, so also did the people lose confidence in them. How hesitating did they seem, the Lords of the Age of Gold, speaking with deliberation, aware of the weight of their word! Thus they accomplished all things with success; and the people deemed their well-being to be the natural course of events.

No trust given, no trust received. The best ruler rules without fanfare. When his work is successful, the people say, "Fantastic! We've done it!" up

Chapter 18

. When the Way is Forgotten When the great Way is forgotten, the doctrines of humanity and morality arise. When knowledge and cleverness appear, there emerges great hypocrisy.	When people try to improve upon, and thus deviate from, the way Nature itself naturally functions, they develop artificial codes of right and wrong. When knowledge becomes highly abstract, men are deceived by mistaking abstractions for realities.	When people deviate from their nature Friendliness and righteousness became merits to be earned Knowledge and cleverness came into being and lying started to rule	THE DECAY OF MANNERS When men abandoned the Way of the Tao, benevolence and justice became necessary. Then also was need of wisdom and cunning, and all fell into illusion.	When the Tao is not followed, kindness and morality appear. When intelligence and learning are exalted, pretentiousness emerges.
When family relationships are not in harmony, filial piety and parental love are advocated. When a country falls into chaos and disorder, there is praise of loyal patriots. up	When instinctive family sympathies are replaced by rules for proper conduct then parents become "responsible" and children become "dutiful". When corruption replaces genuine benevolence in government, then loyalty oaths are demanded of officials. up	Relatives came into conflict with each other and loving each other became a duty Cause when mankind and families get confused Allegiance becomes an order up	When harmony ceased to prevail in the six spheres it was needful to govern them by manifesting Sons. When the kingdoms and races became confused, loyal ministers had to appear.	When there is no peace and order in the family, then we get all kinds of talk about "family values." When the country is badly governed and in chaos, we then glorify patriotism. up

Chapter 19

. What People Need Abandon religion and discard cleverness, and people will benefit a hundredfold. Abandon humanity and discard morality, and people will rediscover love and duty.	Therefore - If we ignore intricate learning and knowledge of petty distinctions, we shall be many times better off. If we neglect to insist upon the formal proprieties of etiquette, our intuitive sympathies will return.	Dispose yourself of worldly knowledge and cleverness And it will only be good for mankind Stop pretending to be nice and fair, but be it Then people will love each other unconditionally Dispose yourself of the work of your hands	RETURNING TO THE PURITY OF THE CURRENT If we forgot our statesmanship and our wisdom, it would be an hundred times better for the people. If we forgot our benevolence and our justice, they would become again like sons, folk of good will.	Discard learning and knowledge, and the people will be a hundred times happier. Banish kindness and morality, and the people will rediscover love and duty.
Abandon skill and discard profit, and there will be no thieves or robbers. These three things relate to externals and are inadequate. People need what they can depend on: reveal simplicity; embrace the natural; control selfishness; reduce desires. up	If we abolish opportunities for profiteering "within the law," incentive for political corruption will disappear. If the foregoing three principles are unclear, then at least the following are understandable: Simply be yourself. Act naturally. Refrain from self-assertiveness. Avoid covetousness. up	and stop serving your self-interest And there will be no thieves or robbers anymore But these three things won't be enough What it's really about is turning back to simplicity Giving up your selfishness and not wishing for anything up	If we forget our machines and our business, there would be no knavery. These new methods despised the olden Way, inventing fine names to disguise their baneness. But simplicity in the doing of the will of every man would put an end to vain ambitions and desires.	Forget about industry and profit, and there won't be any thieves. When these three things are done, more will be required: Look at plain silk; hold uncarved wood; let self dwindle; let desire fade. up

Chapter 20

				No more learning, no more trouble. Is there any real difference between "Ahhh!" and "Yuk!"? What about "good" and "evil"? Must I fear what others fear? Ridiculous! Everybody else is smiling, having fun as if at a festival or carnival. I alone am drifting, not knowing whether I'm coming or going, like a baby before it has learned to smile.
--	--	--	--	---

				Others have what they need; I have nothing. I might as well be homeless. I'm a fool. Very confused. Others are bright; I am dim. Others are sharp; I am dull, lost at sea, without direction. Others have plans; I am aimless. I am different from others. I am nourished by the Great Mother. up
--	--	--	--	--

Chapter 21

. Within the Elusive Way All-embracing power proceeds only through the Way. What is called the Way is elusive and intangible. Intangible and elusive, yet within it are thought-images. Elusive and intangible, yet within it are objects. Deep and obscure, yet within it is the life-force.

Intelligence consists in acting according to Nature. Nature is something which can neither be seen nor touched. Yet all of the forms which can possibly be seen or touched are latent within it. And all of the things that will actually be seen or touched are embedded as potentialities within it. Deep in its depths are activating forces.

A righteous and blissful life is approachable only when you follow your conscience. The conscience is invisible and impalpable. How can you follow it?

THE INFINITE WOMB The sole source of energy is the Tao. Who may declare its nature? It is beyond Sense, yet all form is hidden within it. It is beyond Sense, yet all Perceptibles are hidden within it. It is beyond Sense, yet all Perceptibles are hidden within it.

Te flows from Tao. Tao is elusive and evasive. Evasive and elusive, yet within it there are ideas. Elusive and evasive, yet within it are entities. Dark and obscure, yet within it there is life.

The life-force is very real, and within it is certainty. From the ancient times till now its manifestations have never ceased, by which we may see the beginning of all things. How do I know that the beginnings of all things are so? Through this certainty. up

No matter how unplumbable the depths, these forces unfailingly sustain the world as it appears to us. From the beginning until now, they have never ceased to express themselves in appearances. How do I know all this to be so? It is intuitively self-evident, for every existing thing testifies to it, including what appears right here and now. up

It is beyond Sense, yet all Being is hidden within it. This Being excites Perception, and the Word thereof. As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, its Name operateth continuously, causing all to flow in the cycle of Change, which is Love and Beauty. How do I know this? By my comprehension of the Tao.

The life of the Tao is so real; it gives rise to certainty. From the beginning until now, it has appeared in countless forms, it has been given countless names. How do I know this? Like this! up

Chapter 22

. Yielding for Unity To yield is to preserve unity. To bend is to become straight. To empty oneself is to become full. To wear oneself out is to be renewed. To have little is to be content. To have abundance is to be troubled. Therefore the wise embrace the One and become examples for the world. They do not display themselves and are therefore illumined.		Dissension becomes unity The impure becomes pure The voids shall be filled The old becomes new One who has nothing, receives everything One who has a lot, receives nothing One who is wise cherishes simplicity and in this way he is an example to the world He is modest	THE GUERDON OF MODESTY The part becometh the whole. The curve becometh straight; the void becometh full; the old becometh new. He who desireth little accomplisheth his Will with ease; who desireth many things becometh distracted. Therefore, the sage concentrateth upon one Will, and it is as a light to the whole world.	To be whole, let yourself break. To be straight, let yourself bend. To be full, let yourself be empty. To be new, let yourself wear out. To have everything, give everything up. The Tao Master clings to the Tao and becomes a model for all. He doesn't put on a show, but his light shines forth.
They do not justify themselves and are distinguished. They do not make claims and are therefore given credit. They do not seek glory and therefore are leaders. Because they do not compete, the world cannot compete with them. Is not the ancient saying true, "To yield is to preserve unity?" for true wholeness comes from turning within. up		and therefore he excels He doesn't have to prove himself and that's why people trust his words He has nothing to defend and therefore he is invulnerable So the aphorism of the wise of old "The imperfect becomes perfect" is true The perfect considers the world as his home up	Hiding himself, he shineth; withdrawing himself, he attracteth notice; humbling himself, he is exalted; dissatisfied with himself, he gaineth force to achieve his Will. Because he striveth not, no man may contend against him. That is no idle saw of the men of old; 'The part becometh the whole'; it is the Canon of Perfection.	He doesn't justify himself, but he is known for his integrity. He doesn't boast, but he is recognized as accomplished. He doesn't contend with others, and thus no one contends with him. The old saying, "Surrender and conquer," is not an empty slogan. Surrender to the Tao and find yourself completed. up

Chapter 23

. Nature Nature says few words. A whirlwind does not last all morning, nor does a rainstorm last a whole day. What causes them? Nature. If even Nature's utterances do not last long, how much less should human beings'? Those who follow the Way are one with the Way.

Things which act naturally do not need to be told how to act. The wind and rain begin without being ordered, and quit without being commanded. This is the way with all natural beginnings and endings. If Nature does not have to instruct the wind and the rain, how much less should man try to direct them?

One who knows oneself doesn't need a lot of words. A whirlwind doesn't last all morning. A shower doesn't last a whole day. Where do wind and rain come from? They sprout from nature. If nature doesn't endure its rains and storms, then why should a human being have to talk so much?

THE VOID OF NAUGHT To keep silence is the mark of one who is acting in full accordance with his Will. A fierce wind soon falleth; a storm-shower doth not last all day. Yet Heaven and Earth cause these; and if they fail to make violence continue, how much less can man abide in spasm of passion!

Much talk is contrary to nature. The wind doesn't blow all morning. The rain doesn't fall all day. Wind and rain are caused by nature. If nature restrains herself, shouldn't people do the same? He who follows the Tao is one with the Tao.

Those who follow power are one with power. Those who abandon it are one with abandonment. Those one with the Way are welcomed by the Way. Those one with power are welcomed by power. Those one with abandonment are welcomed by abandonment. Those who lack trust will not be trusted. up

Whoever acts naturally is Nature itself acting. And whoever acts unintelligently is unintelligence in action. By acting naturally, one reaps Nature's rewards. So by acting intelligently, one achieves intelligent goals. Whereas by acting unintelligently, one comes to an unintelligent end. Those who do not trust Nature as a model cannot be trusted as guides. up

So the One who follows his conscience, coincides with his conscience. One who lives an exemplary life, will be an example. One who loses oneself, doesn't know who he is anymore. One who finds oneself, finds bliss. One who loses oneself, loses true life. One who does not trust oneself, will not be trusted. up

He who is virtuous is one with Virtue [Te]. He who loses the Tao becomes a loss. Surrender to the Tao, and it will be your home. Practice virtue [Te], and it will be your abode. Lose the Tao, and you will then reside in loss. No trust given, no trust received. up

Chapter 24

. Avoid Excess
Those who stand on tiptoe are not steady. Those who strain their strides cannot long keep up the pace. Those who display themselves do not illuminate. Those who justify themselves are not distinguished.

One who tries to stand on tiptoe cannot stand still. One who stretches his legs too far cannot walk. One who advertises himself to much is ignored. One who is too insistent on his own views finds few to agree with him.

One who stands on tiptoe, doesn't stand firmly One who walks in a forced way, doesn't come far One who is vain, doesn't shine One who justifies oneself, isn't credible One who

EVIL MANNERS
He who standeth a-tiptoe standeth not firm; he who maketh rigid his legs walketh ill. He who preeneth himself shineth not; he who talketh positively is vulgar; he who boasteth is refused acceptance; he who is wise in his own conceit is thought inferior.

He who stands on tiptoe does not stand firm. He who walks fast cannot walk far. He who shows off does not shine forth. He who pushes will not succeed.

Those who make claims are not given credit. Those who seek glory are not leaders. According to the Way these are like extra food and waste, which all creatures detest. Therefore followers of the Way avoid them. up

One who claims too much credit does not get even what he deserves. One who is too proud is soon humiliated. These, when judged by the standards of Nature, are condemned as "Extremes of greediness and self-destructive activity." Therefore, one who acts naturally avoids such extremes. up

brags, will be unmasked One who works one's way up, humiliates oneself To a wise man these are nothing but follies One who lives righteously and honestly, refrains oneself from these things up

Such attitudes, to him that hath the view given by understanding the Tao, seem like garbage or like cancer, abhorrent to all. They then who follow the Way do not admit them.

He who boasts will not achieve. He who praises his own work creates nothing that endures. These things inspire disgust. Followers of the Tao spurn them. up

Chapter 25

. The Supreme
There is something mysterious and whole which existed before heaven and earth, silent, formless, complete, and never changing. Living eternally everywhere in perfection, it is the mother of all things. I do not know its name; I call it the Way. If forced to define it, I shall call it supreme. Supreme means absolute.

Before Creation revealed itself
There was already something, perfect but formless Quiet and unchanging Ubiquitous and inexhaustible
People might consider it as the creating force of everything that is I cannot describe it, but I just call it Tao
If I have to interpret it , I would name it "The Universe" With that Universe I mean that which extends itself everywhere The infinitely extending and returning

IMAGES OF THE MYSTERY
Without Limit and Perfect, there is a Becoming, beyond Heaven and Earth. It hath nor motion nor Form; it is alone, it changeth not; it extendeth all ways; it hath no Adversary. It is like the All-Mother. I know not its Name, but I call it the Tao. Moreover, I exert myself, and call it Vastness. Vastness, the Becoming!

Before the birth of Heaven and Earth, there was something without form but complete. Silent. Empty. Independent. Unchanging. Infinite. Eternal. It is the Mother of all things. I cannot classify it, but I call it Tao.

Absolute means extending everywhere. Extending everywhere means returning to itself. Thus the Way is supreme. Heaven is supreme. Earth is supreme. And the person is supreme. There are four supremes in the universe, and the person is one of them. The person reflects the earth. The earth reflects heaven. Heaven reflects the Way. And the Way reflects its own nature. up

Therefore the creative is great and the creation great and so is a wise man So there is a trinity of greatnesses and one of them is the true human being
A true human being follows his nature, nature and all its eternally unchanging laws
The laws of nature are the eternal order of the Universe
The order of the Universe is well-founded by the Unnameable up

Becoming, it flieth afar. Afar, it draweth near. Vast is this Tao; Heaven also is Vast; Earth is vast; and the Holy King is vast also. In the Universe are Four Vastnesses, and of these is the Holy King. Man followeth the formula of Earth; Earth followeth that of Heaven, and Heaven that of the Tao. The formula of the Tao is its own Nature.

Powerful, it creates all things, is present in all things, returns all things to their origin. The Tao is great. Heaven is great. Earth is great. Humanity is great. These are the four great things. Humanity follows Earth. Earth follows Heaven. Heaven follows Tao. Tao follows its own nature. up

Chapter 26

. Self-mastery Gravity is the foundation of levity. Serenity masters hastiness. Therefore the wise travel all day without leaving their baggage.	Saneness or sobriety is more basic than frivolity. Calmness or self-sufficiency is superior to being agitated. Therefore the intelligent man, though he goes on a long journey, will never depart far from his means of conveyance.		THE NATURE OF MASS Mass is the fulcrum of mobility; stillness is the father of motion. Therefore the sage King, though he travel afar, remaineth near his supplies. Though opportunity tempt him, he remaineth quietly in proper disposition, indifferent.	Heavy is the foundation of light. Stillness is the source of movement. Thus, the Taoist Master travels all day without losing sight of the baggage cart. He is not swept away by splendid scenery. He remains quiet and unperturbed.
In the midst of honor and glory they remain leisurely and calm, How can a leader of a great country behave lightheartedly and frivolously? In frivolity, the foundation is lost. In hasty action, self-mastery is lost. up	No matter how exciting the distractions, he never submits to their lures. What would happen if Nature were to act frivolously? If it became frivolous, it would be deprived of its sanity. If it became agitated, it would lose control of itself. up	One who knows his grandeur, comes loose of the world One who wanders restlessly in that world, has lost oneself up	Should the master of an host of chariots bear himself frivolously? If he attack without support, he loseth his base; if he become a raider, he forfeiteth his throne.	Why should the lord of the land allow himself to be swept away? Allow yourself to be swept away, and you lose your foundation. Allow yourself to be moved, and you lose self-mastery. up

Chapter 27

. Using the Light A good traveler leaves no trace. A good speaker makes no slips. A good accountant uses no devices. A good door needs no bolts to remain shut. A good fastener needs no rope to hold its bond. Therefore the wise are good at helping people, and consequently no one is rejected.				Following the Tao, the Tao■Master leaves no tracks, speaks without error, counts without markers. No locks on his door, and yet no one can open it. No rope used, and yet his knots cannot be untied. Thus, the Tao■Master cares for all beings and neglects none.
They are good at saving things, and consequently nothing is wasted. This is called using the Light. Therefore the good teach the bad, and the bad are lessons for the good. Those who neither value the teacher nor care for the lesson are greatly deluded, though they may be learned. Such is the essential mystery. up		unconditionally Therefore he is shepherd of the whole creation And respects every thing that lives and grows People call this: "The light that has become human" Therefore a true human being is a mirror for the untrue And it's his task to point out their imperfections One who is scared to take a look at oneself and does not love oneself Might know a lot of things, but he is blind It seems odd, but it's true up	This is called the Occult Regimen. The adept is then master to the zelator, and the zelator assisteth and honoreth the adept. Yet unless these relations were manifest, even the most intelligent observer might be perplexed as to which was which. This is called the Crown of Mystery.	Thus, he follows the light. The Tao■Master teaches the fool; and thus the fool learns. But teaching and learning will not take place unless the student values the teacher and the teacher loves the student. This is the subtle secret of teaching and learning. up

Chapter 28

. The Valley of the World Know the male and keep to the female. Become the valley of the world. Being the valley of the world is eternal power and returning to the innocence of a baby. Know the bright and keep to the obscure. Become an example for the world.		One who knows his strength and yet stays mild, is the least Whoever is the least, is balanced like the open-minded child he once was One who has fathomed the lie is an example for the world One who became human again	THE RETURN TO SIMPLICITY Balance thy male strength with thy female weakness and thou shalt attract all things, as the ocean absorbeth all rivers; for thou shalt formulate the excellence of the Child eternal, simple, and perfect. Knowing the light, remain in the Dark. Manifest not thy Glory, but thine obscurity. Clothed in this Child-excellence eternal, thou hast attained the Return of the First State.	Know the male, maintain the female: become the channel of all things. Become the channel of all things, and true power [Te] will endure. You will be reborn. Know the white, maintain the black: become the form of all things. Become the form of all things, and true power [Te] will endure.
Being an example for the world is eternal power and returning to the infinite. Know glory and keep to humility. Become the valley of the world. Being the valley of the world is eternal power and returning to the natural. Breaking up the natural makes instruments. The wise use them and become leaders. Therefore a leader does not break. up		is an example for the world One knowing oneself, is a knowing among the ignorant One who has returned to his original purity, realizes his grandeur One who has abandoned his origin, becomes civilized To the wise man they are like actors up		You will return to the Infinite. Know honor, maintain humility: become the valley of all things. Become the valley of all things, and true power [Te] will endure. You will find the simplicity of nature. Uncarved wood, when carved by the Tao■Master, becomes a well■governed state. The best carving is that which is not carved at all. up

Chapter 29

Whenever someone sets out to remold the world, experience teaches that he is bound to fail. For Nature is already as good as it can be. It cannot be improved upon. He who tries to redesign it, spoils it. He who tries to redirect it, misleads it.

One who thinks he is capable of improving Creation, will not succeed. Creation is perfect and cannot be corrected. One who intervenes in nature, will only destroy nature. One who tries to control nature, will lose to nature. Because everything is what it is and

REFRAINING FROM ACTION
He that, desiring a kingdom, exerteth himself to obtain it, will fail. A Kingdom is of the nature of spirit, and yieldeth not to activity. He who graspeth it, destroyeth it; he who gaineth it, loseth it.

Do you think you can control the world? I don't think so. The world belongs to the Tao. It can't be controlled. If you mess with it, you'll ruin it. If you try to grab it, you'll lose it.

Consider how Nature operates: Some things precede while others follow. Some things blow one way while some blow another. Some things are strong while others are weak. Some things are going up while others are going down. Therefore the intelligent man avoids both extremes, shunning excess in one way as well as in the other. up

everything happens as it happens. At times it is warm and then it is cold. At times there are storms and then it's calm. There is growth and then there is lying down. A wise man lets himself flow along with the streams of life. up

The wheel of nature revolveth constantly; the last becometh first, and the first last; hot things grow cold, and cold things hot; weakness overcometh strength; things gained are lost anon. Hence the wise man avoideth effort, desire and sloth.

Some things move on; others remain behind; some things are hot; others are cold; some things are strong; others are weak; some things are up; others are down. The Tao Master renounces extremes, excess, and extravagance. up

Chapter 30

Whoever tries to help Nature run itself does not need to use force. For force will be met with force, and wherever force is used fighting and devastation follows. After the battle come years of destitution. He who is wise lets well enough alone. He does not press a victory by further conquest. When peace has been restored, he does not behave like an arrogant victor.

One who advocates a righteous world, uses no violence Because One who uses violence, provokes violence And where discord rules there is chaos And after times of conflict lean years will follow The righteous one does what he can and forces nothing Is not proud about what he achieves Does

A WARNING AGAINST WAR If a king summon to his aid a Master of the Tao, let Him not advise recourse to arms. Such action certainly bringeth the corresponding reaction. Where armies are, are weeds. Bad harvests follow great hosts. The good general striketh decisively, once and for all.

How to govern in accordance with the Tao: No conquest by force of arms. Weapons always turn back against themselves. Encamp an army today; the campground is all thorns and brambles tomorrow. Make war for a month; there will be famine for years.

When security has been regained, he does not gloat like a conqueror. When he gets what he needs, he does not destroy those who have been defeated. Whenever he does something which he has to do, he does it without cruelty. When things reach maturity, they decay of themselves. So cruelty is unnatural. Whoever acts unnaturally will come to an unnatural finish. up

not brag about what he achieves Does not boast about what he achieves He only does what he does because that's all he can do And he never uses power or violence Civilizations which have reached their peaks Usher in their decay Civilizations are unnatural And what's unnatural, will perish up

He does not risk by overboldness. He striketh, but doth not vaunt his victory. He striketh according to strict law of necessity, not from desire of victory Things become strong and ripe, then age. This is discord with the Tao; and what is not at one with the Tao soon cometh to an end.

Do what needs to be done, but do not rejoice in victory. Make war, if necessary, and win, but without arrogance, without hostility, without pride, without needless violence. War, victory, and the rest do not last. They are contrary to Tao. What is contrary to Tao perishes quickly. up

Chapter 31

How ingenious
weaponry may
seem to be,
though it will
always be
disastrous rubbish
Everybody hates it
A righteous man
saves himself from
it While a true man
will not soil his
hands with it A
fighter grabs for it
Weapons are not
good for meek
people They bring
nothing but trouble
One who is wise
will never ever use
a weapon
Because peace
and quietness are
more precious to

Weapons
generate fear; all
creatures hate
them. Therefore,
the Tao■Master
tries not to use
them He
uses them only
when there is no
alternative, and
then without joy,
in a calm and
restrained way.

him He doesn't
enjoy victory
Because one who
enjoys victory
Enjoys his fellow
men getting killed
And one who
enjoys their fellow
men getting killed
Will never find
peace in oneself
Prosperity is
considered as a
personal merit
Misfortune on the
other hand is
considered as an
ironic freak Victory
is the merit of men
And defeat the
blame of the
commander But
victory and defeat
only brings losers
up

At feasts, the left
hand is the high
seat; at funerals,
the right. The
second in
command of the
army leadeth the
left wing, the
commander-in-
chief, the right
wing; it is as if the
battle were a rite
of mourning! He
that hath slain
most men should
weep for them
most bitterly; so
then the place of
the victor is
assigned to him
with philosophical
propriety.

Enjoy weapons,
enjoy killing.
Enjoy killing, lose
yourself The
killing of many
people should
create sorrow
and grief. A great
victory is a
funeral
ceremony. up

Chapter 32

Nature is always indeterminable. Although, in its original simplicity, it may appear to be helpless, no one else can tell it what to do. If legislators and administrators could keep this in mind, everybody would obey their laws without enforcement. When opposites supplement each other, everything is harmonious. Without compulsion, each supports the other.

The Unspeakable is eternal and is not to be spoken of in words. Just like a rough piece of wood, it's not useful to anyone. If leaders were an example of true living, everyone would join his true nature at the same time. The heavens would dew and the clouds rain justice. And without human intervening, that altogether would

THE WISDOM OF THE Tao. The All-Tao hath no name. It is that Minute Point yet the whole world dare not contend against him that hath it. Did a lord or king gain it and guard it, all men would obey him of their own accord. Heaven and Earth combining under its spell, shed forth dew, extending throughout all things of its own accord, without man's interference.

The Tao cannot be named or defined. It is invisible, but it contains all things. If rulers could master it, then everything would fall into place. Heaven and Earth would be united. A sweet rain would fall. People would be just without regulation.

But when boundaries between opposites appear, then the boundary lines are marked out. Once one begins to differentiate between one thing and another, how will we know where to stop? To know when to stop making distinctions is to be free from error. The true relationship of every determinate thing to Nature is reintegrative, like all the rivers and rivulets ever running to their ocean. up

benefit every single thing that lives beneath the firmament. But when discord is born, everything must have a name. Keep in mind that when everything has a name, you'll have to stop all that. Because one who stops will bounce off danger. Compared to the twisted tributaries of mistake, the straight and simple road is like a powerful stream. up

Tao, in its phase of action, hath a name. Then men can comprehend it; when they do this, there is no more risk of wrong or ill-success. As the great rivers and the oceans are to the valley streams, so is the Tao to the whole universe.

However, when people seek to rule, they divide the whole and begin assigning names to things. And now, there are names upon names. Too many! The naming must stop. Knowing when to stop saves us from danger. Tao in the world is like rivers flowing into the sea. up

Chapter 33

. Inner Power Those who know others are wise. Those who know themselves are enlightened. Those who overcome others require force. Those who overcome themselves need strength.	He who knows much about others may be learned, but he who understands himself is more intelligent. He who controls others may be powerful, but he who has mastered himself is mightier still.	One who sees through the other is clever One knowing oneself is wise One who conquers the other is powerful One conquering oneself is inviolable One who is satisfied is	THE DISCRIMINATION (VIVEKA) OF THE He who understandeth others understandeth Two; but he who understandeth himself understandeth One. He who conquereth others is strong; but he who conquereth himself is stronger yet.	Knowing others is a kind of knowledge; knowing yourself is wisdom. Conquering others requires strength; conquering yourself is true power [Te].
Those who are content are wealthy. Those who persevere have will power. Those who do not lose their center endure. Those who die but maintain their power live eternally. up	He who receives his happiness from others may be rich, but he whose contentment is self-willed has inexhaustible wealth. He who occupies a place provided for him by others may live a long life, but he who dwells in his own self-contained place, even though he decays, is eternal. up	rich One that wants a lot is busy all the time One who stays oneself, is a four-square fellow One who dies before dying, lives in the present forever up	Contentment is riches; and continuous action is Will. He that adapteth himself perfectly to his environment, continueth for long; he who dieth without dying, liveth for ever.	To realize that you have enough is true wealth. Pushing ahead may succeed, but staying put brings endurance. Die without perishing, and find the eternal. up

Chapter 34

. The Great Way
The great Way
flows
everywhere, both
left and right. All
things derive
their life from it,
and it does not
turn away from
them. It
accomplishes its
work, but does
not take
possession.

Ultimate reality is
all-pervasive; it is
immanent
everywhere. All
other things owe
their existence to it
and draw their
sustenance from it,
without anyone
being refused.
Having created
and and nurtured
them, it does not
demand title to
them. Even though
it has provided for
all, it refuses to
dominate over a
single one.

That which makes
everything exist, is
present
everywhere It
spreads itself
throughout the
entire Creation
Everything owes
its existence to It,
everything to its
own nature It gives
everything for
nothing It
cherishes and
guards everything
and everyone, but
expects nothing in

THE METHOD OF
ATTAINMENT The
Tao is immanent; it
extendeth to the
right hand as to
the left. All things
derive from it their
being; it createth
them, and all
comply with it. Its
work is done, and
it proclaimeth it
not. It is the
ornament of all
things, yet it
claimeth not fief of
them; there is
nothing so small
that it inhabiteth
not, and informeth
it.

The Tao is like
an overflowing
river. It rises to
the left and to the
right. The ten
thousand things
arise from it, but
do not depart
from it. The Tao
acts, but cannot
be defined. It
clothes and
nourishes all
beings, but does
not rule over
them.

It provides for
and nourishes
everything, but
does not control
them. Always
without desires, it
may be
considered
small. The
destination of all
things, yet
claiming nothing,
it may be
considered great.
Because it never
claims
greatness, its
greatness is
achieved. up

Since it asks
nothing in return
for its services, it
may appear as of
little worth. But all
things return home
to it again, even
though they do not
know that they are
being called home.
Therefore it may
be thought of as
ultimate. Since it
never claims
ultimacy for itself,
it is, by that very
fact, ultimate
indeed. up

return Because It
does not wish for
anything, It seems
to be important It
makes everything
appear and
disappear again
But Itself is eternal
Therefore the one
who is wise is
modest And
because he is
modest, His
actions are grand
up

All things return
without knowledge
of the Cause
thereof; there is
nothing so great
that it inhabiteth
not, and informeth
it. In this manner
also may the Sage
perform his Works.
It is by not
thrusting himself
forward that he
winneeth to his
success.

It endures
without desire
and without
seeming "big."
The ten
thousand things
find their home in
it, and yet it does
not exercise
lordship over
them. The Tao is
very great, but it
does not show its
greatness.
Therefore, it is
truly great. up

Chapter 35

. The Inexhaustible Way Hold to the great form, and all the world follows, following without meeting harm, in health, peace, and happiness.	He who grasps the ultimate structure of reality draws everyone to him. They approach him without being harmed, but find security, satisfaction, and contentment. Particular goods of various kinds attract the interests of men as they travel through life. But the all-pervasive way of Nature attracts no attention to itself (for its true nature is not found to be in particulars).	For one who beholds the perfect arrangement of things Everything falls in its rightful place Nothing can harm him, and rest and peace will fall to him Along the way	THE GOOD WILL OF THE TEH The whole world is drawn to him that hath the likeness of the Tao. Men flock unto him, and suffer no ill, but gain repose, find peace, enjoy all ease.	Kapitel nicht vorhanden /
--	--	---	--	----------------------------------

Music and delicacies to eat induce travelers to stay. But the Way is mild to the taste. Looked at, it is invisible. Listened to, it is inaudible. Applied, it is inexhaustible. up	Even though it is present in the mouth, it remains untasted. Even though it is embedded in all objects, it remains unseen. Even though it permeates sound, it remains unheard. Yet, no matter how much we use it, it can never be exhausted. up	there are travellers who yield music and feasts Because the road to self-knowledge is acrid and unpleasant Not pleasant to face Painful to hear But giving an inexhaustible strength up	Sweet sounds and cates lure the traveler from his way. But the Word of the Tao; though it appear harsh and insipid, unworthy to hearken or to behold; hath his use all inexhaustible.	chapter not available up
---	--	--	--	---------------------------------

Chapter 36

. The Mystic Light In order to contract, it is necessary first to expand. In order to weaken, it is necessary first to strengthen. In order to reduce, it is necessary first to build up.

The purpose of contracting (returning to Nature) is served by expanding (emerging out of Nature in the first place). The purpose of weakening (subsiding or satisfying of desire) is served by strengthening (arousing the will to live). The purpose of decline (of individual self-assertion) is served by arising (of individuality).

Only what's stretched out can be pulled together Only what's fortified can be weakened Only what's increased can be decreased Only one who

THE HIDING OF THE LIGHT In order to draw breath, first empty the lungs; to weaken another, first strengthen him; to overthrow another, first exalt him; to despoil another, first load him with gifts; this is called the Occult Regimen.

To shrink, you must first expand. To weaken, you must first strengthen. To knock down, you must first raise up. To receive, you must first give.

In order to receive, it is necessary first to give. This is called the mystic Light. The soft and gentle overcome the hard and strong. As fish stay in the deep water, so sharp weapons of the state should not be displayed. up

The purpose of taking away (culminating or perfecting life) is served by being given (ie., "the last of life for which the first was made"). This is the most penetrating insight into the way of life. The giving in or finishing always triumphs over the starting out. Just as a fish should not be taken out of water, So a sword should never be taken from its scabbard. up

has, can lose That must be clear Soft overcomes hard Weak overcomes strong Fishes belong in water Weapons have to be destroyed up

The soft conquereth the hard; the weak pulleth down the strong. The fish that leaveth ocean is lost; the method of government must be concealed from the people.

This is the way things are. Soft overcomes hard. Slow overcomes fast. Fish cannot live out of the water. A nation's best weapons should not be displayed. up

Chapter 37

. The Way Never Interferes The Way never interferes, yet through it everything is done. If leaders would follow the Way, the world would be reformed of its own accord.

Nature never acts, yet it activates everything. If legislators and administrators would behave likewise, each thing would develop in accordance with its own nature.

The Eternal Creating does nothing And yet it does everything If leaders would give in to it The aspect of the world would change of itself But since people have so

THE RIGHT USE OF GOVERNMENT The Tao proceedeth by its own nature, doing nothing; therefore there is no doing which it comprehendeth not. If kings and princes were to govern in this manner, all things would operate aright by their own motion.

The Tao never acts, yet through it everything gets done. If rulers could reside in the Tao, everything would fall into place all by itself.

When reformed and desiring to act, let them be restrained by what is simply natural. Undefined simplicity is free of desires. Being free of desires, it is serene; and the world finds peace of its own accord. up

Just as, when things develop, those which become passionate are restrained by that passionless one which activates them, So the way to restrain men's passions is by dispassionate restraint. And thus all passions will subside. up

much to wish for Only I can be an example The example of true simplicity And when the people decide to follow me The whole world will be in peace up

If this transmutation were my object, I should call it Simplicity. Simplicity hath no name nor purpose; silently and at ease all things go well.

Action is restrained by the Tao. Action restrained, no desire. No desire: tranquillity. All things at peace. up

Chapter 38

--	--	--	--	--

				Thus, when the Tao is lost, virtue arises. When virtue is lost, morality arises. When morality is lost, justice arises. When justice is lost, propriety arises. Propriety is merely a shadow of justice, morality, and virtue; it is the beginning of chaos Therefore, the Tao■Master stays with the Tao. He does not live on the surface of things. He looks to the fruit, not to the flower. He accepts this [Tao] and rejects that [non■Tao]. up
--	--	--	--	--

Chapter 39

--	--	--	--	--

			The root of grandeur is humility, and the strength of exaltation in its base. Thus rulers speak of themselves as 'Fatherless,' 'Virtueless,' 'Unworthy,' proclaiming by this that their Glory is in their shame. So also the virtue of a Chariot is not any of the parts of a Chariot, if they be numbered. They do not seek to appear fine like jade, but inconspicuous like common stone.	Therefore, the humble is be root of the noble; the lowly is the foundation of the high; rulers call themselves "orphans," "widows," and "worthless." This is taking the humble and the lowly as the root and foundation, is it not? You can have all the parts of a chariot without having a chariot. Better to rumble like rocks than to tinkle like jade. up
--	--	--	--	---

Chapter 40

. Movement of the Way
Returning is the movement of the Way. Gentleness is the method of the Way.

Nature alternates dynamically.
When it completes what it is doing, then it starts all over again.

One who deviates from the right and simple road Will be pulled towards it again This occurs

OMITTING
UTILITY The Tao proceeds by correlative curves, and its might is in weakness.

Reversal is the motion of the Tao. Yielding is the way of the Tao.

All things in the world come from being, and being comes from non-being. up

All that is springs from such alternation. up

with a mild touch
The whole creation comes into existence
The existing out of the unnameable
unexisting up

All things arose from the Teh, and the Teh budded from the Tao.

All things emerge from being.
Being emerges from non-being. up

Chapter 41

			THE IDENTITY OF THE DIFFERENTIAL The best students, learning of the Tao, set to work earnestly to practice the Way. Mediocre students now cherish it, now let it go. The worst students mock at it. Were it not thus mocked, it were unworthy to be Tao. Thus spake the makers of Saws: the Tao at its brightest is obscure.	When a thoughtful man hears of the Tao, he tries to follow it. When an average man hears of the Tao, he wonders about it, but then tends to forget it. When a fool hears of the Tao, he makes fun of it. If someone didn't make fun of it, it wouldn't be the Tao.
--	--	--	--	---

Great purity appears tarnished. Great character appears insufficient. Solid character appears weak. True integrity appears changeable. Great space has no corners. Great ability takes time to mature. Great music has the subtlest sound. Great form has no shape. The Way is hidden and indescribable. Yet the Way alone is adept at providing for all and bringing fulfillment. up			Who advanceth in that Way, retireth. Its smooth Way is rough. Its summit is a valley. Its beauty is ugliness. Its wealth is poverty. Its virtue, vice. Its stability is change. Its form is without form. Its fullness is vacancy. Its utterance is silence. Its reality is illusion. Nameless and imperceptible is the Tao; but it informeth and perfecteth all things.	Therefore, when seeking the Tao, light seems dark, advancing feels like retreating, the simple appears difficult, power is like weakness, purity seems tarnished, true virtue seems deficient and unsteady, and the clear seems obscure. The true square has no corners. The true vessel never sails. The true sound is hard to hear. The true form has no shape. The Tao is hidden, beyond definition; but it alone fulfills. up
--	--	--	---	--

Chapter 42

. All Things The Way produced the One; the One produced two; two produced three; and three produced all things. All things have the receptivity of the female and the activity of the male. Through union with the life force they blend in harmony.

Nature first begets one thing. The one thing begets another. The two produce a third. In this way, all things are begotten. Why? Because all things are impregnated by two alternating tendencies, the tendency towards completion and the tendency towards initiation, which acting together, complement each other.

The unspeakable gives birth to one One to a second And out of the second arises the third The third brings the whole creation to life Everything is carried by the dark and comes to light The breath of Emptiness creates order People hate to be alone, unimportant and

THE VEILS OF THE TAO The Tao formulated the One. The One exhaled the Two. The Two were parents of the Three. The Three were parents of all things. All things pass from Obscurity to Manifestation, inspired harmoniously by the Breath of the Void.

Out of Tao, One. Out of One, Two. Out of Two, Three. Out of Three, all things. All things carry Yin and face Yang. Out of the union of Yin and Yang, harmony.

People hate being orphaned, lonely, and unworthy. Yet kings and nobles call themselves such. Often gain can be a loss, and loss can be a gain. What others teach, I teach also: "The violent die a violent death." I shall make this primary in my teaching. up

Most men dislike to be considered of no account, lowly, unworthy. Yet intelligent leaders call themselves thus. For people are admired for their humility and despised for their pride. There are many other ways of illustrating what I am teaching: "Extremists reach untimely ends." This saying may be taken as a good example. up

useless And yet that is what a true man takes pleasure in One who becomes smaller, becomes bigger One who becomes bigger, becomes smaller I only tell what everybody already knows: One who lives in a complicated way, dies in a complicated way That is what it's all about up

Men do not like to be fatherless, virtueless, unworthy: yet rulers describe themselves by these names. Thus increase bringeth decrease to some, and decrease bringeth increase to others. Others have taught thus; I consent to it. Violent men and strong die not by natural death. This fact is the foundation of my law.

No one wants to be "orphaned," "widowed," or "unworthy." But kings and princes use these words as titles for themselves. You win by losing. You lose by winning. It has been said, and I agree, "A violent man dies violently." up

Chapter 43

. The Value of Non-action The softest things in the world overcome the hardest. Non-being penetrates even where there is no space.	That which is most yielding eventually overcomes what is most resistant. That which is not becomes that which is.	The softest is stronger than the very hardest That which makes everything be what it is, penetrates everything Therefore I know that it's wise to leave and not	THE COSMIC METHOD The softest substance hunteth down the hardest; the unsubstantial penetrateth where there is no opening.	The softest thing overcomes the hardest thing. That which has no substance can enter where there is no space.
Through this I know the value of non-action. Teaching without words and the value of non-action are understood by few in the world. up	Acting without coercing or being coerced is best. Guiding by example rather than by words is most successful. Such simple truths are so hard to understand. up	do anything That one doesn't need lessons for it That of all doings, leaving is where true happiness lies In this world only a few understand this up	Here is the Virtue of Inertia. Few are they who attain: whose speech is Silence, whose Work is Inertia.	This shows the value of non-■ado. Teaching without words; doing without ado: hard to accomplish. up

Chapter 44

. How to Endure Fame or your life, which do you love more? Life or material wealth, which is more valuable? Loss or gain, which is worse? Therefore those who desire most spend most. Those who hoard most lose most. Those who are contented are not disappointed. Those who know when to stop prevent danger. Thus they can long endure.	Esteem by others or self-esteem, which is better? To value things or to value yourself, which is better? To have more or to have less, which is worse? The more you have, the more you have to lose.	What comes first, life or status? What's more important to you, yourself or your possessions? What's worse, having or losing?	MONITORIAL What shall it profit a man if he gain fame or wealth, and lose his life?	Fame or self: which matters more? Self or possessions: which is more valuable? Loss or gain: which is worse? Attachment to things brings suffering.
up 45. Skill Seems Awkward The greatest perfection seems incomplete, but its utility is never impaired. The greatest fullness seems empty, but its use cannot be exhausted. What is most direct seems devious. The greatest skill seems awkward. The greatest eloquence seems like stuttering. Movement overcomes cold. Stillness overcomes heat. The serene and calm are guides for all. up	The more you value things, the less you value your self. The more you depend on others for esteem, the less you are self-sufficient. He who knows how to discriminate wisely avoids danger, And continues safely on his way. up	One who wants a lot pays a high price One who has a lot, has a lot to lose But one who is satisfied knows neither fear nor disgrace And one who has stopped playing a part in the game will never be afraid again and will live happily ever after up	If a man cling to fame or wealth, he risketh what is worth more. Be content, not fearing disgrace. Act not, and risk not criticism. Thus live thou long, without alarm.	Much hoarded, much to be lost. Know when enough is enough. Avoid disgrace. Know when to stop. Avoid danger. This is how to endure. up

Chapter 45

What is most complete is still incomplete: Yet it is as complete as it can be. That which has achieved the most, still has the whole of its future yet to be achieved: Hence it will not stop achieving. Make a thing as straight as possible; Yet it is still crooked or will become crooked.

Perfection seems unfinished to this world But it never perishes
Fullness is empty to the world But it's inexhaustible
That which is correct, is incorrect to the world

THE
OVERFLOWING
OF THE Despise thy masterpieces; thus renew the vigor of thy creation. Deem thy fullness emptiness; thus shall thy fullness never be empty.

The perfect seems flawed, but its usefulness is unlimited. Full seems empty, but it is inexhaustible. Straight seems bent. Intelligent seems stupid.

Acquire the greatest skill; And there will still be endless skill to be acquired. Develop the greatest power of expression; And there will be much that is unexpressed and inexpressible. The same may be said about activity and passivity and cold and heat. Only he who fully accepts these alternations is the best guide for all to follow. up

Wisdom seems foolish to the world Telling the truth a disgrace
Like movement chases away coldness And rest cools down
Purity and calmness show one the right direction up

Let the straight appear crooked to thee, thy Craft clumsiness; thy Musick discord. Exercise moderateth cold; stillness heat. To be pure and to keep silence, is the True Law of all that are beneath Heaven.

Eloquent seems tongue■tied. Motion defeats the cold. Stillness defeats the heat. The Tao■Master remains calm as a guide for all things. up

Chapter 46

. Contentment
When the world lives in accord with the Way, horses work on farms. When the world does not live in accord with the Way, the cavalry practices in the parks.

When what is natural prevails in human affairs, horses forced to train for racing are returned to the fertile pastures. When artificiality prevails in human affairs, horses are trained for war and are restricted to walled enclosures. There is no greater evil than desiring to change others - (to take from or give to others what they do not, of their own accord, want to give or take).

If men lived by their nature
Horses would gallop in the open air But since men got civilized Battle horses standing at the frontier
There is no bigger curse

THE
WITHDRAWAL
FROM
AMBITION When the Tao beareth away on Earth, men put swift horses to night-carts. When it is neglected, they breed chargers in the border marches.

When the kingdom is in harmony with the Tao, the horses haul manure. When the kingdom departs from the Tao, war■horses are bred in the land.

The greatest temptation to crime is desire. The greatest curse is discontent. The greatest calamity is greed. Whoever is content with contentment is always content. up

There is no greater misfortune than desiring to change oneself - being discontented with one's lot. There is no greater vice than desiring to change things - (to possess, control, or reconstruct their natures). Only he who is satisfied with whatever satisfactions his own nature provides for him is truly satisfied. up

than dissatisfaction
Nothing more disastrous than being discontent with life Nothing more fatal than being eager for possessions One who knows the peace of satisfaction, is always satisfied up

There is no evil worse than ambition; no misery worse than discontent; no crime greater than greed. Content of mind is peace and satisfaction eternal.

There is no greater curse than wanting more than enough. There is no greater sin than greed. He who knows when enough is enough always has enough. up

Chapter 47

. Understanding
One can know
the world without
going outside.
One can see the
Way of heaven
without looking
out the window.

Without going
out-of-doors, one
can know all he
needs to know.
Without even
looking out of his
window, one can
grasp the nature
of everything.
Without going
beyond his own
nature, one can
achieve ultimate
wisdom.

Without leaving
my house, I
understand the
whole world
Without looking
outside, I see the
perfect order The
more you know,

THE VISION OF
THE DISTANT
One need not
pass his
threshold to
comprehend all
that is under
Heaven, nor to
look out from his
lattice to behold
the Tao
Celestial. Nay!

You can know
the whole world
without going out
the door, You
can know the
Way of Heaven
without looking
out the window.

The further one
goes the less
one knows.
Therefore the
wise know
without going
about,
understand
without seeing,
and accomplish
without acting.
up

Therefore the
intelligent man
knows all he
needs to know
without going
away, And he
sees all he
needs to see
without looking
elsewhere, And
does all he
needs to do
without undue
exertion. up

the less you'll
understand One
who is wise
doesn't need to
travel He
understands
without looking
Does nothing but
achieves
everything up

but the farther a
man goeth, the
less he knoweth.
The sages
acquired their
knowledge
without travel;
they named all
things aright
without
beholding them;
and, acting
without aim,
fulfilled their
Wills.

The further afield
you go, the less
you know. The
Tao Master
knows without
going out;
understands
without looking;
achieves without
ado. up

Chapter 48

While day by day the overzealous student stores up facts for future use, He who has learned to trust nature finds need for ever fewer external directions. He will discard formula after formula, until he reaches the conclusion: Let Nature take its course.

Gathering knowledge makes life more complicated each time one gathers
Gathering wisdom makes life easier each time one gathers
Each time, more and more simple until simplicity is reached
Just by leaving, one man can

Pursue learning, gain daily. Follow the Tao, lose daily. By losing day■by■day, you arrive at non■ado. Nothing done, nothing left undone.

By letting each thing act in accordance with its own nature, everything that needs to be done gets done. The best way to manage anything is by making use of its own nature; For a thing cannot function properly when its own nature has been disrupted. up

achieve everything
One who wants nothing anymore, doesn't feel the need to do a thing, has conquered oneself
One who wants a lot has to do a lot and is as a slave to oneself up

Master the world by letting things be, by letting them take their own course. The world can't be conquered. up

Chapter 49

The intelligent man is not willful. He accepts what others will for themselves as his will for them. Those who appear as good, he accepts, And those who appear as bad, he accepts; For Nature accepts both.

A wise man has no opinion at all. Therefore he can easily put himself in someone else's position. He accepts everybody and everything for what it is. In spite of any behaviour, He trusts the honest and the unfair. And naturally they become

The Tao■Master does not have his heart set on anything in particular. He wants to understand the hearts of the people. He is good to people who are good. He is also good to people who aren't good. This is true goodness.

Those who appear faithful, he accepts, And those who appear unfaithful, he accepts; For Nature accepts both. The intelligent man treats every kind of nature impartially, And will good to one as much as the another. All people admire the intelligent man, Because he regards them all as a mother regards her children. up

fair-minded. He trusts the reliable and the unreliable. And naturally all will become reliable. A wise man feels one with all people. They are all just as precious to him. They look and listen to him. And all are as children to him up

He trusts people who are trustworthy. He also trusts people who aren't trustworthy. This is true trust. The Tao■Master radiates peace and harmony. Through him, the hearts of the people are made one. Are the people his children, or is he their child? up

Chapter 50

It is natural for man to be born and to die. And it is natural for each of his parts to be born and to die and to evolve through its life cycle. Why do men become so perturbed and anxious to prolong the life of each part when endangered? The truth is that whatever is natural is good.

Humans come and go Their bodies as the seat of life Their bodies as the seat of death Humans get old and decay Why is that?

Come into life, go into death. Three out of ten have a lust for life. Three out of ten have a lust for death. Three out of ten just pass from birth to death without appreciating either life or death. Why is this? Because none of them appreciates both life and death.

Since it is natural for man to die anyway, being assisted by horn or claw or spear in bringing about his death in no way endangers his nature. No wild buffalo horn can change the course of Nature. No tiger's claw can act unnaturally. No soldier's spear can go against Nature. Why? Because death is natural, but Nature cannot die. up

But there are those [one out of ten?] who appreciate both life and death. When they travel the country, they are not attacked by rhinos and tigers. When they go into battle, they are not wounded. The rhino finds nothing to gore. The tiger finds nothing to claw. Weapons find nothing to pierce. Why? Because such people have gone beyond death. up

Chapter 51

. Mystical Power
The Way produces all things. Power nourishes them. Matter gives them physical form. Environment shapes their abilities. Therefore all things respect the Way and honor power. The Way is respected, and power is honored without anyone's order and always naturally.

Nature produces things, and intelligence guides them. Although different in kind, each thing has its own self-sufficient intelligence to guide it. Nothing can fail to emulate Nature and intelligence by embodying them within its own life. Such emulation is not demanded, but occurs of its own accord.

The Unspeakable makes all things appear The active force determines their nature Their nature determines their shape The circumstance determines their final appearance Therefore all creatures, With the exception of erring mankind, honour the Unspeakable And live according to their natures This is all a natural process And nobody rewards them for

THE TEH AS THE NURSE All things proceed from the Tao, and are sustained by its forth-flowing virtue. Every one taketh form according to his nature, and is perfect, each in his particular Way. Therefore, each and every one of them glorify the Tao, and worship its forth-flowing Virtue. This glorifying of the Tao, this worship of the Teh, is constantly spontaneous, and not by appointment of Law.

Tao gives birth to the ten thousand things. Te nurtures them. They are formed from matter and completed by environment. Therefore, the ten thousand things honor Tao and respect Te, not in response to commandments, but just naturally.

Therefore the Way produces all things, and power nourishes them, caring for them and developing them, sheltering them and comforting them, nurturing them and protecting them, producing them but not possessing them, helping them but not obligating them, guiding them but not controlling them. This is mystical power. up

Nature originates and suckles, rears and develops, protects and provides for, and guides and perfects all things. Whatever is produced, Nature accepts it for what it is. However it behaves, Nature lets it follow its own way. Whatever its fortune, Nature injects no external interference. Such is Nature's marvelous sagacity. up

it The Unspeakable makes them live, feeds them, makes them grow Fulfills them, gives them peace, supports and guards them It makes them live, but never forces them It takes them along the stream of life, but does not possess It makes mature, but does not control That is an unfathomable mystery up

Thus the Tao buddeth them out, nurtureth them, developeth them, sustaineth them, perfecteth them, ripeneth them, upholdeth them, and reabsorbeth them. It buddeth them forth, and claimeth not lordship over them; it is overseer of their changes, and boasteth not of his puissance; perfecteth them, and interfereth not with their Ways; this is called the Mystery of its Virtue.

Tao gives birth to the ten thousand things, and Te nurtures, rears, develops, shelters, and protects them. But Tao and Te do not try to own or rule the ten thousand things, nor do they seek to make them dependent. This is true power. up

Chapter 52

. Practicing the Eternal The beginning of the universe is the mother of all things. Those who discover the mother understand the children. Understanding the children and returning to the mother, they live always free from harm. Close the mouth, shut the doors, and all of life is without strain.

Nature, because it has mothered all, may be regarded as Mother Nature. He who understands Mother Nature, understands her children. But to avoid the children's mistakes, one should follow close to Mother Nature herself. If throughout his life he desires a safe guide.

The world sprouts from something People could call it the mother of the world When one knows that mother, one knows her child One who becomes like that child again, will know the mother And for the rest of his life nothing can harm him ever again He won't criticize anyone and lets no one influence him And his life will be without worries But one who

THE WITHDRAWAL INTO THE SILENCE The Tao buddeth forth all things under Heaven; it is the Mother of all. Knowing the Mother, we may know her offspring. He that knoweth his Mother, and abideth in Her nature, remaineth in surety all his days. With the mouth closed, and the Gates of Breath controlled, he remaineth at ease all his days.

The world's Source, the Mother of all things. Knowing the Mother, we know her children. Knowing the children, but holding on to the Mother, we are free from the fear of death.

Open the mouth, meddle with affairs, and all of life is beyond help. Seeing the small is insight; to stay with the gentle is strength. Use the Light, return to insight, and thereby be preserved from harm. This is practicing the eternal. up

If one remains silent and keeps to himself, he will not fail to fulfill his life; But is he gives advice and meddles in others' affairs, he invites trouble. If you see what is small as it sees itself, And accept what is weak for what strength it has, and use what is dim for the light it gives, Then all will go well. This is called acting naturally. up

condemns others and whose interests concern only himself Will be full of worries the rest of his life One that sees a gleam of light in darkness sees the light at the end of the tunnel Holding on to that gleam of light requires strength One who follows that light, turns back to the original light Then all danger is gone And you'll live the eternal life up

With the mouth open, and the Breath directed to outward affairs, he hath no surety all his days. To perceive that Minute Point is True Vision; to maintain the Soft and Gentle is True Strength. Employing harmoniously the Light Within so that it returneth to its Origin, one guardeth even one's body from evil, and keepeth Silence before all men.

Stop talking, withdraw from the rat■race, and life is full. Blab on, lose yourself in busy■ness, and life is lost. Seeing the small requires good vision. Yielding is strength. Turn to the Inner Light, and find the eternal. up

Chapter 53

. Leaders in Robbery Those with even a scrap of sense walk on the main way and fear only straying from the path. The main way is smooth and easy, but people like to be side-tracked.	Let us be intelligent and follow Nature itself. Let us not stray. Nature's way is simple and easy, but men prefer the intricate and artificial.		THE WITNESS OF GREED Were I discovered by men, and charged with government, my first would be lest I should become proud. The true Path is level and smooth; but men love by-paths. They adorn their courts, but they neglect their fields, and leave their storehouses empty.	If I had any sense, I would walk on the main road [the Tao], and I would fear leaving it. Keeping to the main road [the Tao] is so easy, and yet people love to stray from it as they seek shortcuts. Look!
While the courts are arrayed in splendor, the fields are full of weeds, and the granaries are empty. Yet some wear embroidered clothes, carry sharp swords, over-indulge themselves with food and drink, and have more possessions than they can use. They are leaders in robbery. This is not the Way. up	When they congregate in artistically engineered cities, and neglect their farms, their food supply is cut off. When they bedeck themselves with ornaments and weapons, and display their fancy foods and rich properties, they thereby invite thievery. This is acting unnaturally. up	up	They wear elaborate and embroidered robes; they gird themselves with sharp swords; they eat and drink with luxury; they heap up goods; they are thievish and vainglorious. All this is opposite to the Way of Tao.	The royal palace is magnificent, but the fields are full of weeds, and the granaries are empty. Some are beautifully dressed and bejeweled, wearing flashy weapons on their belts, eating and drinking until they burst. These people■these state■sanctioned crooks■ have far more than they need. Surely, this isn't the Tao! up

Chapter 54

. Power What is well established cannot be uprooted. What is firmly held cannot slip away. The power of sacrifice continues on from generation to generation. Cultivated in the person, power becomes real. Cultivated in the family, power becomes abundant. Cultivated in the community, power endures.			THE WITNESS OF WISDOM If a man plant according to the Tao it will never be uprooted; if he thus gather, it will never be lost. His sons and his son's sons, one following another, shall honour the shrine of their ancestor. The Tao, applied to oneself, strengtheneth the Body, to the family, bringeth wealth; to the district, prosperity; to the state, great fortune.	Kapitel nicht vorhanden /
Cultivated in the nation, power flourishes. Cultivated in the world, power becomes universal. Therefore see the person as a person, the family as a family, the community as a community, the nation as a nation, and the world as universal. How do I know that the world is like this? By this. up	If he inspires in in the whole country, his benefit will become universal. Thus one's own individual life serves as an example for other individuals. One's family life serves as an example for other individuals. One's family life serves as a model for other families. One's community serves as a standard for other communities. One's state serves as an ideal for other states. How do I know all this? It is obvious. up	Because I've done this myself up	Let it be the Law of the Kingdom, and all men will increase in virtue. Thus we observe its effect in every case, as to the person, the family, the district, the state, and the kingdom. How do I know that this is thus universal under Heaven? By experience.	chapter not available up

Chapter 55

. Know Harmony Those filled with power are like new-born children. Poisonous insects will not sting them; ferocious beasts will not pounce upon them; predatory birds will not swoop down on them. Their bones are pliable, their muscles tender, but their grip is firm. They have never known the union of man and woman, but the organ is fully formed, meaning that the vital essence is strong.	He who is intelligent is like a little child. Poisonous insects do not sting him. Ferocious beasts do not attack him. Wild birds do not claw him. His bones are soft, his muscles weak, yet his grip is strong. Because he has no urge for sexual union, he is fully satisfied. His vitality is intact. He can cry all day without getting hoarse.	A true human being is like a new-born baby. Wasps and scorpions won't sting it, snakes and adders won't bite it. Raptors and wild animals won't attack it. Its bones and muscles are soft and flexible, yet it has a pretty tight grip. Sex and libido are strange to it, but its little penis already is able to stiffen. That is because its nature is not yet disturbed by	THE SPELL OF THE MYSTERY He that hath the Magick powers of the Tao is like a young child. Insects will not sting him or beasts or birds of prey attack him. The young child's bones are tender and its sinews are elastic, but its grasp is firm. It knoweth nothing of the Union of Man and Woman, yet its Organ may be excited. This is because of its natural perfection.	Kapitel nicht vorhanden /
---	---	--	---	----------------------------------

They may cry all day without getting hoarse, meaning that the harmony is perfect. To know harmony is to be in accord with the eternal. To know the eternal is to be enlightened. To try to force life is ominous. To force the vital essence with the mind is violence. The prime is past, and decay follows, meaning that it is contrary to the Way. Whatever is contrary to the Way will soon perish. up	His existence is harmonious. To know such harmony is to be in accord with Nature. To be in accord with Nature is to be achieving the goal of life. But to seek excitement is to invite calamity. Those too eager for activity soon become fatigued. For when things exhaust their vigour, they age quickly. Such impatience is against Nature. What is against Nature dies young. up	thoughts It can yell all day without getting a hoarse throat. Because everything is still perfectly in balance. Experiencing that balance is called "living in the eternal present". Living without past or future is called "being wise". Every attempt to extend life is pointless. One who wants to control his life, restrains oneself. It is unnatural that things wither. That which is unnatural will come to an early end. up	It will cry all day long without becoming hoarse, because of the harmony of its being. He who understandeth this harmony knoweth the mystery of the Tao, and becometh a True Sage. All devices for inflaming life, and increasing the vital Breath, by mental effort are evil and factitious. Things become strong, then age. This is in discord with the Tao, and what is not at one with the Tao soon cometh to an end.	chapter not available up
---	---	--	--	---------------------------------

Chapter 56

. Mystical Unity
Those who know
do not speak.
Those who
speak do not
know. Close the
mouth; shut the
doors. Smooth
the sharpness;
untie the tangles.
Dim the glare;
calm the turmoil.

He who is wise
keeps silent. He
who advises is a
fool. The wise
man shuts his
mouth, Closes
his doors, Curbs
his anxieties,
Withdraws from
entanglements,
Remains
untempted by
attractions, And
retains his
self-sufficiency.
Nature is
profoundly
impartial.

Those who have
experienced the
Mystery don't
speak about it
Those who do
speak about it
have not
experienced the
Mystery Don't try
to speak about the
Unspeakable That
which cannot be
seen, heard, felt or
tasted The shapes
fade The edges
weaken

THE
EXCELLENCE
OF THE
MYSTERY Who
knoweth the Tao
keepeth Silence;
he who babbleth
knoweth it not.
Who knoweth it
closeth his
mouth and
controlleth the
Gates of his
Breath. He will
make his
sharpness blunt;
he will loosen his
complexes; he
will tone down
his brightness to
the general
obscurity.

Those who know
do not tell. Those
who tell do not
know. Stop
talking, withdraw
from the
rat■race, calm
your spirit,
untangle
yourself, soften
your glare. Be
one with the dust
of the earth.

This is mystical
unity. Those
achieving it are
detached from
friends and
enemies, from
benefit and
harm, from honor
and disgrace.
Therefore they
are the most
valuable people
in the world. up

It cannot be
persuaded by
pampering, Nor
dissuaded by
scoffing. It
cannot be
tempted by
bribes, Nor
influenced by
injury. It cannot
be cajoled by
flattery, Nor
chagrined by
slander. Thus it
is the most
reliable thing in
the world. up

Confusion
disappears The
light brightens The
unrest is
extinguished
That's what they
call a "Mystical
Experience"
Neither affection
nor hate can move
him Profit nor loss
will touch him
Honour nor
disgrace will harm
him Therefore he
is the world's
noblest man up

This is called the
Secret of
Harmony. He
cannot be
insulted either by
familiarity or
aversion; he is
immune to ideas
of gain or loss, of
honour or
disgrace; he is
the true man,
unequalled under
Heaven.

This is primal
union. Achieving
union with the
Tao places one
beyond attraction
and repulsion,
benefit and
harm, honor and
disgrace. This is
the highest state
of being. up

Chapter 57

. Love Peace States are governed by justice. Wars are waged by violations. The world is mastered by nonintervention. How do I know this? By this: The more restrictions there are, the poorer the people. The more sharp weapons, the more trouble in the state.		With laws men rule a state With ruses people make war Without laws and without ruses you'll have a peaceful mankind How do I know this?	THE TRUE INFLUENCE One may govern a state by restriction; weapons may be used with skill and cunning; but one acquireth true command only by freedom, given and taken. How am I aware of this? By experience that to multiply restrictive laws in the kingdom impoverisheth the people; the use of machines causeth disorder in state and race alike.	In governing, employ no surprises. In waging war, employ only surprises. Win the world with non■ado. How do I know this? Like this! The more rules and regulations there are, the poorer the people become. The more experts there are, the more confusion there is. The more skillful and clever technicians there are, the more horrifying inventions are produced.
The more clever cunning, the more contrivances. The more rules and regulations, the more thieves and robbers. Therefore the wise say, "Do not interfere, and people transform themselves. Love peace, and people do what is right. Do not intervene, and people prosper. Have no desires, and people live simply." up	This is why the intelligent man concludes: When I attend to my own business, other people are able to attend to theirs. When I exemplify self-reliance, other people will devote themselves to the exercise of their own intelligence. When I make no demands upon them, other people themselves will prosper. When I express no desire to interfere in their lives, others will become genuinely self-sufficient. up		The more men use skill and cunning, the more machines there are; and the more laws there are, the more felons there are. A wise man has said this: I will refrain from doing, and the people will act rightly of their own accord; I will love Silence, and the people will instinctively turn to perfection; I will take no measures, and the people will enjoy true wealth; I will restrain ambition, and the people will attain simplicity.	The more "law and order" there is, the higher the crime■rate. Therefore, the Tao■Master says, I do nothing, and the people govern themselves. I practice keeping quiet, and the people find justice. I seek emptiness, and the people prosper. I have no desires, and the people return to a natural and simple life. up

Chapter 58

. Results of Process When the government is relaxed, people are happy. When the government is strict, people are anxious. Good fortune leans on bad fortune; bad fortune hides behind good fortune. Who knows the results of process?	When government governs little, people are happy. When government governs much, people are miserable. Thus happiness depends on little, And misery depends on much. What does the desire to govern come to? To restrict interferers is itself interference. So attempts to increase happiness end only in misery. Mankind has been foolish for so long a time!	The fewer rules and laws there are, the happier mankind will be The more rules and laws, the more there will be of dissatisfaction and conflicts Someone's wealth comes at the expense of someone else's poverty Misery for one is the result of someone else's wealth When will this ever stop?	ADAPTATION TO ENVIRONMENT The government that exerciseth the least care serveth the people best; that which meddleth with everybody's business worketh all manner of harm. Sorrow and joy are bedfellows; who can divine the final result of either? Shall we avoid restriction? Yea; restriction distorteth nature, so that even what seemeth good in it is evil.	When the government is restrained, the people are happy and satisfied. When the government meddles in everything, the people are disgruntled and miserable. Happiness eclipses misery. Misery eclipses happiness. Which will it be?
Is there no justice? When the just become unjust, goodness becomes evil. People have been deluded for a long time. Therefore the wise are square but not cornered, sharp but not cutting, straight but not strained, brilliant but not dazzling. up	The intelligent man knows what is best, but does not make others conform. He knows directions, but does not direct. He pursues the straightest way to the goal, but does not urge others to deviate from their course. He is enlightened, but he cares not whether others see his light. up	One who is wise is righteous and won't play that game He is just and fair and will never hurt anybody He shines, but does not blind up	For how long have men suffered from misunderstanding of this. The wise man is foursquare, and avoideth aggression; his corners do not injure others. He moveth in a straight line and turneth not aside therefrom; he is brilliant but doth not blind with his brightness.	The straight becomes crooked. Good becomes evil. The people remain bewildered. Thus, the Tao■Master is sharp but not cutting, incisive but not biting, straight but not controlling, bright but not glaring. up

Chapter 59

. Be Frugal In leading people and serving heaven it is best to be frugal. Being frugal is to be prepared from the start. Being prepared from the start is to build up power. By building up power nothing is impossible.

In managing men or anything else, the intelligent man uses self-restraint. Only by self-restraint can one forestall trouble. Forestalling trouble strengthens one's position. Such strengthened position enables one to withstand everything. Withstanding everything, one remains unchallenged.

To get mankind to live in peace requires a full detachment. Because only one who is detached knows how to live truthfully. Letting go of everything before dying makes one live righteously. One who lives righteously knows no trouble. For one who knows no trouble,

WARDING THE TAO . To balance our earthly nature and cultivate our heavenly nature, tread the Middle Path. This Middle Path alone leadeth to the Timely Return to the True Nature. This Timely Return resulteth from the constant gathering of Magick Powers. With that Gathering cometh Control.

In governing the country and serving Heaven, show restraint. Showing restraint is submission to the Tao. Submission to the Tao will fill you with Te. Being filled with Te, there will be no limit to your power, and there will be nothing you cannot overcome.

If nothing is impossible, then there are no limits. Those without limits are capable of leading a country. Those with maternal leadership can long endure. This is to be deeply rooted in a firm foundation, the way of long life and eternal vision. up

Being unchallenged, one governs easily. Because he embodies Mother Nature within himself, he retains a sound position. This is the way to be deeply rooted and firmly based, And durable and long-lived. up

life is unbounded. One who is unbounded, considers the world as his home. One who feels united with creation, lives happily ever after. Then you'll be rooted again and you'll stand firmly. Only like that will you live happily ever after and understand everything. up

This Control we know to be without Limit and he who knoweth the Limitless may rule the state. He who possesseth the Tao continueth long. He is like a plant with well-set roots and strong stems. Thus it secureth long continuance of its life.

When there is nothing you cannot overcome, you will be a true ruler indeed. You will be one with the country. You will be the Mother of the country. Being the Mother of the country, you will have deep roots and a firm base. Your reign will be long-lasting. This is the Tao of long life and eternal vision. up

Chapter 60

. Spirits Leading a large country is like cooking a small fish. When the world is led in accord with the Way, spirits lose their powers.

Whether governing a big country or cooking a little fish, follow Nature's way and no evil tendencies will get control.

Making sure that mankind lives in peace is a trifle
Where righteousness is the main guide, delusions won't last
Not that there will be no delusions at all
But the people will be less

THE DUTY OF GOVERNMENT
The government of a kingdom is like the cooking of fish. If the kingdom be ruled according to the Tao, the spirits of our ancestors will not manifest their Teh.

Rule a large country as you would cook a small fish. Follow the Tao, and evil will be subdued.

It is not that they lose their powers, but that their powers no longer harm people. Not only do the spirits not harm people, but the wise also do not harm people. Not harming each other, spiritual power grows. up

This does not mean that the dangers of evils can be eliminated entirely, but only that they will cease to harm men. When ordinary men are unharmed, their leaders are unharmed. And when nobody harms anybody, perfect harmony prevails. up

susceptible to them
Delusions damage people, and a wise man shows them it's so
Therefore a wise man is a threat to delusion, But no threat for mankind
Therefore they will become wise, too up

These spirits have this Teh, but will not turn it against men. It is able to hurt men; so also is the Wise King; but he doth not. When these powers are in accord, their Good Will produceth the Teh, endowing the people therewith.

Evil will still be there, but it won't be able to do much harm. The Tao Master does no harm. If no harm is done, then the power of the Tao can flow on. up

Chapter 61

To be great, a state must be passively receptive, like the ocean which accepts whatever the rivers bring into it, or like the feminine which always submits to the masculine. Recall how the female always overcomes the male by means of her passivity. Passivity is submissiveness. Thus the great state places itself at the service of a small state before before it absorbs the small state.

When mankind lives in peace, There will be no superiors and inferiors It is like a big river, In which all side currents have come to rest The wildness comes to rest in peacefulness, Because it is calm

THE MODESTY OF THE THE A state becometh powerful when it resembleth a great river, deep-seated; to it tend all the small streams under Heaven. It is as with the female, that conquereth the male by her Silence. Silence is a form of Gravity.

A great country is like a sea into which all streams flow, the Female of the world. The Female overcomes the Male with stillness. The woman overcomes the man by lying underneath him. Therefore, a great country dominates a small country by submitting to it; and a small country can dominate a great country by submitting to it.

And a small state must serve the interests of the great state before it can be taken into the great state. Hence, some submit in order to take, while others submit in order to be taken. When a great state desires to have more people, and a small state desires to be protected, it is by submission that both obtain what they desire. up

and most lowly One who is the least by his disarming simplicity, Is therefore appealing to his fellow men And so it's a benefit for both of them So one who looks big, has to become small again up

Thus a great state attracteth small states by meeting their views, and small states attract the great state by revering its eminence. In the first case this Silence gaineth supporters; in the second, favour. The great state uniteth men and nurtureth them; the small state wisheth the good will of the great, and offereth service; thus each gaineth its advantage. But the great state must keep Silence.

Yield and conquer. A great country wants to unite and shelter people. A small country wants to come in and be sheltered. Each gets what it wants. Thus, the great country should yield. up

Chapter 62

Nature is profoundly worth while. It is that which is most worth while for good men, And it is the only real value for bad men. Flattery may gain favours, and gifts may help one to advance, But bad men know how to flatter and bribe.

Everything inclines towards the original balance It's the bliss of true men It's a sanctuary for the untruthful But people flaunt themselves with flattery They only do nice things in exchange for gratitude Everybody does that so why shouldn't you?

THE WORKINGS OF THE TAO The Tao is the most exalted of all things. It is the ornament of the good, and the protection and purification of the evil. Its words are the fountain of honour, and its deeds the engine of achievement. It is present even in evil.

The Tao is the source of all things, the good man's treasure, the bad man's refuge. You can buy beautiful words. You can build your reputation with good deeds. But even bad people can use beautiful words and perform good deeds.

Therefore when leaders are installed in office, Better than he who artfully gives lavish gifts and glowing tribute, Is one who, by doing nothing but accepting his natural role as a follower, pays genuine homage. Why have men always valued Nature? Was it not because Nature submitted humbly to the task of benefiting the good and the bad alike? Is this not the reason why it is the most worth while thing in the world? up

Therefore the people shout with joy when a new leader comes on the scene And let themselves be fooled by pomp and circumstance It's wise not to participate in this Do you know why the former wise people considered simplicity so important? Because they experienced that, one who seeks will find And that the truth sets one free from past and future Therefore simplicity is most important in this life up

So when the new emperor is crowned (and the three ministers of state are installed), do not send gifts of jade and four■horse chariots. Instead, be still, and offer the Tao. The ancients treasured the Tao because, when you seek it, you find it; through the Tao, even sinners receive forgiveness. That is why everybody loves the Tao. up

Chapter 63

. The Wise Never Strive Act without interfering. Work without doing. Taste the tasteless. Large or small, many or few, repay injury with goodness. Handle the difficult while it is still easy. Handle the big while it is still small. Difficult tasks begin with what is easy.		Act without intention Stop labouring Just enjoy life One who doesn't honour something small Isn't worthy of something big No more eye for an eye and tooth for a tooth Turn to them your other cheek Discover that what seems complicated is in fact very simple See the grandeur in what seems insignificant Don't turn simplicity into complexity Living purely is simple But people	FORETHOUGHT AT THE OUTSET Act without lust of result; work without anxiety; taste without attachment to flavour; esteem small things great and few things many; repel violence with gentleness. Do great things while they are yet small, hard things while they are yet easy; for all things, how great or hard soever, have a beginning when they are little and easy.	Act without ado; work without effort. Taste the tasteless; treat the small as large and the few as many. Reward evil with goodness. Take on the difficult while it is still easy, the large while it is still small. Difficult always begins as easy; large always begins as small.
Great accomplishments begin with what is small. Therefore the wise never strive for the great and thus achieve greatness. Rash promises inspire little trust. Taking things too lightly results in much difficulty. Thus the wise always confront difficulties and therefore have no difficulty. up		have made it complicated So one who's wise will never make trouble And therefore he can move mountains One who promises a lot is hardly ever trustworthy One with a lot of blinkers on will bring to pass lots of troubles But one who is wise looks before he leaps Therefore he won't start at all And because of that he knows no trouble up	So thus the wise man accomplisheth the greatest tasks without undertaking anything important. Who undertaketh thoughtlessly is certain to fail in attainment; who estimateth things easy findeth them hard. The wise man considereth even easy things hard, so that even hard things are easy to him.	Therefore, the Tao■Master never tries to be great. As a result, he accomplishes great things. Big promises produce little trust. Treating something as quite easy makes it very difficult. The Tao■Master regards everything as difficult, which means that, for him, everything is easy. up

Chapter 64

--	--	--	--	--

		so he remains himself But people break down everything and they call it “progress” Once started, there is no end to A wise man strives for what others don't And takes to be important what others take to be unimportant He unlearns what other are still learning And turns back to a state of mind others have left Then he knows the way back to the source But realizes that the people do not want to hear about it up	The wise man acteth not, so worketh no harm; he doth not grasp, and so doth not let go. Men often ruin their affairs on the eve of success, because they are not as prudent at the end as in the beginning. The wise man willet what others do not will, and valueth not things rare. He learneth what others learn not, and gathered up what they despise. Thus he is in accord with the natural course of events, and is not overbold in action.	
--	--	---	---	--

Chapter 65

Originally people knew how to follow Nature, For they did not try to arouse in the people an interest in cunning, but let them remained unspoiled. The shrewder people are, the harder they are to govern. Therefore to try to improve government by means of increasing cleverness in people is to endanger it.

The former sages, who travelled along the straight and simple path Brought the people wisdom instead of knowledge When people know much, unity is impossible to keep That's why science disturbs the togetherness of men And wisdom guards

THE PURITY OF THE THE They of old time that were skilled in the Tao sought not to enlighten the people, but to keep them simple. The difficulty of government is the vain knowledge of the people. To use cleverness in government is to scourge the kingdom; to use simplicity is to anoint it.

The ancient rulers who followed the Tao did not try to enlighten the people, but rather aimed at making them dull. People are hard to govern because they are so clever. Rulers who seek to enlighten the people are like bandits who prey upon the land.

But to improve government by encouraging honesty in the people is beneficial. The comprehend the significance of these two ways is to be profoundly intelligent. Profound intelligence is that penetrating and pervading power To restore all things to their original harmony. up

that togetherness One who understands this Understands that wisdom and knowledge are in conflict with each other Once you understand this, you'll be wise And you will turn back to simplicity And feel one with everything and everybody up

Know these things, and make them thy law and thine example. To possess this Law is the Secret Perfection of rule. Profound and Extended is this Perfection; he that possesseth it is indeed contrary to the rest, but he attracteth them to full accordance.

Rulers who forget about enlightening the people are a real blessing to the nation. Remember these two enduring principles: they represent the power [Te] of the Tao. Te goes deep and far. All things turn back and reach original harmony. up

Chapter 66

. Leading from Behind Great rivers and seas are lords of all mountain streams, because they are good at staying below them. Therefore they are lords of the streams. Thus the wise in watching over the people speak humbly from below the people, and in leading the people get behind them.

Rivers and seas dominate the landscape, Because, by being good at seeking the lowest places, they fill and occupy and spread over everything. Likewise the intelligent man is superior to others, Because he admits that he is inferior, And he is a leader of others Because he is willing to be a follower.

Why are the seas and rivers the biggest among all waters?

PUTTING ONE'S SELF LAST The oceans and the rivers attract the streams by their skill in being lower than they; thus are they masters thereof. So the Wise Man, to be above men, speaketh lowly; and to precede them acteth with humility.

Great rivers and seas are kings to hundreds of lesser streams because they lie lower than the lesser streams. To stand above, you must speak from below. To lead, you must follow behind.

In this way the wise watch over the people but do not oppress them; they lead the people but do not block them. Thus everyone happily goes along without getting tired. Because they do not compete, the world cannot compete with them. up

Thus although he is actually superior to others, they do not feel depressed. And when he leads them, they do not feel that they are being forced to obey. So all are happy to give him their support. Since he competes with no one, no one competes with him. up

Because they are located on the lowest places Therefore they are the biggest So one who is wise among fools must be the least And therefore he is the greatest But fools won't consider him as a threat They just don't understand him and take no notice of him Because he doesn't fight and argue with anybody, he is indisputable up

Thus, though he be above them, they feel no burden; nor, though he precede them, do they feel insulted. So then do all men delight to honour him, and grow not weary of him. He contendeth not against any man; therefore no man is able to contend against him.

This is how the ruler who follows the Tao stands above and leads the people. And in this way, the people are neither overburdened nor oppressed. The whole nation supports such a ruler. He contends with no one, and no one contends with him. up

Chapter 67

. Three Treasures
Everyone says the Way is great and beyond comparison. Because it is great, it cannot be compared. If it were compared, it already would have seemed small. I have three treasures to be maintained and cherished: the first is love; the second is frugality; the third is not pushing oneself ahead of others.

Everyone says: "Nature is great, yet Nature is simple." It is great because it is simple. If it were not simple, long ago it would have come to little. Nature sustains itself through three precious principles, which one does well to embrace and follow. These are gentleness, frugality and humility. When one is gentle, he has no fear of retaliation.

In life I am great, but to the world I am a failure. In my grandeur, I am different from all the rest. And that is exactly therefore the reason I am great. If I would be like the rest, I would be just as unimportant and insignificant. I have three treasures I cherish: The first is compassion. The second is austerity. The third is modesty. Thanks to my compassion I can be brave. Because I

THE THREE JEWELS They say that while this Tao of mine is great, yet it is inferior. This is the proof of its greatness. If it were like anything else, its smallness would have long been known. I have three jewels of price where to I cleave; gentleness, economy, and humility.

Many consider my teaching to be nonsense. But the profound is a lot like nonsense. If a teaching does not seem nonsensical, then it must be trivial. I have three treasures to guard and preserve: The first is compassion. The second is self-restraint. The third is not wanting to be ahead of others. Compassion breeds fortitude.

From love comes courage; from frugality comes generosity; from not pushing oneself ahead of others comes leadership. Now courage without love, generosity without frugality, and leadership by pushing oneself ahead of others are fatal. For love wins all battles and is the strongest defense. Heaven gives love to save and protect. up

When one is frugal, he has no fear of retaliation. When one is humble, no one challenges his leadership. When rudeness replaces gentleness, And extravagance replaces frugality, and pride replaces humility, The one is doomed. Since a gentle attack arouses little antagonism, And a gentle defense provokes little anger, Nature predisposes to gentleness those most suited for survival. up

That gentleness maketh me courageous, that economy generous, that humility honoured. Men of today abandon gentleness for violence, economy for extravagance, humility for pride: this is death. Gentleness bringeth victory in fight; and holdeth its ground with assurance. Heaven wardeth the gentle man by that same virtue.

Self-restraint breeds generosity. Not wanting to be ahead of others breeds leadership. These days, people want courage without compassion, generosity without self-restraint, and leadership without the willingness to be led. This is death. Compassion rules! On the attack, it wins. On the defense, it holds the fort. It is Heaven's means of aid and protection. up

Chapter 68

. The Power of Not Striving The best soldier is not violent. The best fighter is not angry. The best winner is not contentious.	The best soldier does not attack. The superior fighter succeeds without violence. The greatest conqueror wins without a struggle. The most successful manager leads without dictating.	One who fights for peace is non-violent A true fighter is unshakeable A true victor does not argue A true leader is the least That's what people call "non-violent defensibility"	ASSIMILATING ONE'S SELF TO HEAVEN He that is skilled in war maketh no fierce gestures; the most efficient fighter bewareth of anger. He who conquereth refraineth from engaging in battle; he whom men most willingly obey continueth silently with his Work.	The best soldier does not rush into battle. The best fighter does not display his anger. The best conqueror does not take vengeance on his enemy.
The best employer is humble. This is known as the power of not striving, as ability in human relations, and as being in accord with heaven. up	This is called intelligent nonaggressiveness. This is called mastery of men. This is called matching the wisdom of the highest and oldest in Nature. up	And that's how one gets the people on his side That is called "living according to your nature" That is the perfection of which the wise of old spoke up	So it is said: 'He is mighty who fighteth not; he ruleth who uniteth with his subjects; he shineth whose will is that of Heaven.'	The best leader is the best follower. This is known as the power [Te] of not contending. This is known as true leadership. This is known as following Heaven's lead. up

Chapter 69

. The Kind Win
The strategists say, "Do not be the aggressor but the defender. Do not advance an inch, but retreat a foot instead." This is movement without moving, stretching the arm without showing it, confronting enemies with the idea there is no enemy, holding in the hand no weapons.

Military maxims say: "It is easier to defend than to attack." "It is better to back away a foot than to assault to gain an inch." This means that the best way to advance is to retreat. He who bares his flesh will appear to have no need for carrying weapons. He who does not flourish weapons appears to have nothing to defend.

One who understands that quarrels will never solve anything, Won't start them anymore and prefers to wait He rather takes a step back or retracts That's what people call winning by losing Showing strength without impressing

THE USE OF THE MYSTERIOUS WAY A great strategist saith: 'I dare not take the offensive. I prefer the defensive. I dare not advance an inch; I prefer to retreat a foot.' Place therefore the army where there is no army; prepare for action where there is no engagement; strike where there is no conflict; advance against the enemy where the enemy is not.

There is a saying among military strategists: "Instead of advancing, I'll be advanced upon; it is better to retreat a foot than to advance an inch." This is known as advancing without advancing, getting ready without showing your muscles, capturing without attacking, being well■armed without weapons.

No disaster is greater than underestimating the enemy. Underestimating the enemy will destroy my treasures. Thus when the battle is joined, it is the kind who will win. up

He who does not prepare to defend himself appears to have no enemies. No one will attack a person unless he appears to be an enemy, For to attack one who is not an enemy is to lose a friend. Therefore, when opposing enemies meet for open battle, he who runs away to hide is the one who wins. up

Standing firm without starting a fight Nothing is more disastrous than underestimating your enemy One who underestimates his enemy exposes oneself to danger Therefore he who's driven by compassion Is always the winner in a conflict up

There is no error so great as to engage in battle without sufficient force. To do so is to risk losing the gentleness which is beyond price. Thus when the lines actually engage, he who regreteth the necessity is the victor.

There is nothing worse than underestimating your enemy. That leads to total defeat. Therefore, when armies clash, it is the side that does not rejoice in war■making that wins. up

Chapter 70

. My Ideas Are Easy My ideas are easy to understand and easy to practice. Yet no one understands them or practices them. My ideas have a source; my actions have a master.

The things I am saying are very easy to understand and very easy to practice. Yet no one in the world can comprehend them fully nor practice them perfectly. The things I am saying did not originate with me but have their source in Nature.

My words are easy to comprehend And easy to bring to practice Yet no one in the world wants to surrender to them And no one feels capable of living according to them My words have an origin, my way of living a

THE DIFFICULTY OF RIGHT APPREHENSION My words are easy to understand and to perform; but is there anyone in the world who can understand them and perform them? My words derive from a creative and universal Principle, in accord with the One Law.

My teachings are very easy to understand and even easier to put into practice. And yet, no one understands or practices them. My teachings are derived from an ancient system of principles.

Because people do not understand this, they do not know me. Since few know me, I am very precious. Therefore the wise wear coarse clothes and keep the jewel inside. up

It is because men do not understand this source that they do not understand me. Since those who understand me are few, they are, for that reason, all the more worthy of emulation. Therefore the intelligent man presents a poor exterior, yet carries Nature's riches embedded in his core. up

principle But because the people do not dare to see this They are not able to understand me There are only a few who understand me and to them I am most precious One who is wise therefore acts unnoticed, but remains oneself up

Men, not knowing these, understand me not. Few are they that understand me; therefore am I the more to be valued. The Wise Man weareth sack-cloth, but guardeth his jewel in his bosom.

People who do not realize this do not really know me. Few know me, but that is my value. Therefore, the Tao Master wears rough clothing, but has a jewel for a heart. up

Chapter 71

. A Disease To know that you do not know is the best. To think you know when you do not is a disease.

To know how little one knows is to have genuine knowledge. Not to know how little one knows is to be deluded. Only he who knows when he is deluded can free himself from such delusion.

Realizing you can't know anything, is wise One who does not understand he can't know anything, is insane One who realizes his insanity, Is able to

THE DISTEMPER OF KNOWLEDGE To know, yet to know nothing, is the highest; not to know, yet to pretend to knowledge, is a distemper.

To know that you do not know is strength. Not knowing that you do not know is a sickness.

Recognizing this disease as a disease is to be free of it. The wise are free of disease, because they recognize the disease as a disease. Therefore they are free of disease. up

The intelligent man is not deluded, because he knows and accepts his ignorance, and accepts his ignorance as ignorance, and thereby has genuine knowledge. up

get rid of it One who is wise is not insane anymore, Because he has disposed of his insanity Therefore he has a clear view up

Painful is this distemper; therefore we shun it. The wise man hath it not. Knowing it to be bound up with Sorrow, he putteth it away from him.

The cure begins with the recognition of the sickness. The Tao■Master is not sick, but he is sick of sickness. Thus, he is well. up

Chapter 72

Do not be irritated when people do not recognize your importance; For if you are really important, sooner or later circumstances will force them to recognize it. Do not treat them contemptuously nor despise them; For only when you do not despise them will they not despise you.

When people have forgotten what to be afraid of, They will live in vague fear Why do they come to terms with this miserable way of living? Why don't they see the beauty of life?

CONCERNING LOVE OF SELF
When men fear not that which is to be feared, that which they fear cometh upon them. Let them not live, without thought, the superficial life. Let them not weary of the Spring of Life!

When the people do not fear your power, then your power has become truly great. Do not intrude into their homes. Do not interfere with their work.

Of these two, one is good, and one is harmful. Some are not favored by heaven. Who knows why? Even the wise consider it a difficult question. The Way of heaven does not strive; yet it wins easily. It does not speak; yet it gets a good response. It does not demand; yet all needs are met. It is not anxious; yet it plans well. The net of heaven is vast; its meshes are wide, but nothing slips through. up

Although the intelligent man knows his own importance, He does not require that others recognize it; and he esteems himself for what he is, But does not insist that others esteem him. He does not seek to be esteemed by others because he recognizes his self-esteem as sufficient. up

Why are they so scared of escaping their rut? One who is wise understands this, and won't flaunt it He enjoys it but doesn't consider it as his own merit He abandons his old way of living and embraces true life up

By avoiding the superficial life, this weariness cometh not upon them. These things the wise man knoweth, not showeth: he loveth himself, without isolating his value. He accepteth the former and rejecteth the latter.

If you do not oppress them, then they will not become sick of you. Thus, the Tao■Master knows himself, but does not show himself. He loves himself, but is not arrogant. Therefore, he lets go of that and chooses this. up

Chapter 73

He whose courage expresses itself as defiance is often put to death. He whose courage manifests itself as patience to endure insult continues to live. Of these two kinds of courage, the one is beneficial, the other harmful. Many people are puzzled as to why, of two courageous men, one is harmed and one benefited. But the intelligent man finds no difficulty with this question.

Having guts and being reckless will lead to death
Having guts and being cautious saves life
The first is useless; the other useful
Only one who is wise understands the course of things
Therefore he won't intervene
It is easy to infringe

ESTABLISHING THE LAW OF FREEDOM
One man, daring, is executed; another, not daring, liveth. It would seem as if the one course were profitable and the other detrimental. Yet when Heaven smiteth a man, who shall assign the cause thereof? Therefore the sage is diffident.

A man of daring courage will kill or be killed. A man of cautious courage seeks to save lives. Each of these may be either beneficial or harmful. Heaven hates what it hates. Who knows why? Even the Tao Master can't figure it out.

Nature itself has the patience to endure insult, yet always wins in the end. It does not explain; nevertheless all understand. It does not command; but all eventually obey. It does not hurry; yet everything is accomplished. Nature's web is so finely woven - wide enough to catch the biggest, fine enough to catch the smallest - that not a single thing escapes. up

upon the eternal laws of nature
But they always triumph
They don't speak, yet they do answer
They don't yell, yet everybody hears them
Like a net, the original order protects the Universe
Though its meshes seem wide, nothing can come through
up

The Tao of Heaven contendeth not, yet it overcometh; it is silent, yet its need is answered; it summoneth none, but all men come to it of their free will. Its method is quietness, yet its will is efficient. Large are the meshes of Heaven's Net; wide open, yet letting none escape.

The Tao does not contend, but it prevails. It does not speak, but it answers. It is not called, but it responds. It has no purpose, but it achieves all of its aims. Heaven's net is wide; nothing slips through. up

Chapter 74

. Death People are not afraid to die. So why threaten them with death? If people were afraid of death, and lawbreakers could be caught and put to death, who would dare to do so? There is the Lord of Death who executes. Trying to do his job is like trying to cut wood for the Master Carpenter. Those who try to cut wood for the Master Carpenter rarely escape injuring their own hands.

It is futile to threaten people with death. If they are not afraid to die, they cannot be frightened by the death penalty; and if they are afraid to die, why should we kill them? Only Nature knows the proper time for a man to die.

When people no longer fear death How can one threaten them with it? But if people are afraid of death and other people threaten to kill them When they infringe upon the law Well, who is still going to break the law?

A RESTRAINT OF MISUNDERS TANDING The people have no fear of death; why then seek to awe them by the threat of death? If the people feared death and I could put to death evil-doers, who would dare to offend?

If people do not fear death, then you cannot threaten them with it. If they are afraid of death, we could make death the penalty for breaking the law. But do we dare to do so?

up 75. Valuing Life People are hungry, because rulers eat too much tax-grain. That is why people are starving. People are hard to govern, because rulers interfere too much. That is why they are hard to govern. People do not care about death, because rulers demand too much of life. That is why they do not care about death. Only those who do not interfere with living are best at valuing life. up

To kill is to interrupt Nature's design for dying, Like a blundering apprentice judging himself to be wiser than his master. Whenever an apprentice thinks he is smarter than his master, he is very likely to hurt himself. up

But there is only One who commands life and death Since people started to decide about life and death themselves They have actually taken a place on that One's chair Then they behave like sorcerer's apprentices Who assault the works of their master, With disastrous consequences for themselves up

There is one appointed to inflict death. He who would usurp that position resembleth a hewer of wood doing the work of a carpenter. Such an one, presumptuous, will be sure to cut his own hands.

Consider the role of the official executioner: Are you ready to play that role? When amateurs try to play the master carpenter, they usually cut and bruise themselves in the process. up

Chapter 75

	Those who make their living by collecting taxes cause the people to starve; when the people starve, the tax collectors, having no one to tax, starve also. Those who govern people make them discontented with being controlled; and therefore cause them to be uncontrollable.	People starve Because the wealthy enrich themselves off other people's backs That's why people starve People cannot be kept under control Because their leaders don't know what they're doing That's why people cannot be	THE INJURY OF GREED In such a state of insecurity it is better to ignore the question of living than to set store by it.	When taxes are too high, people starve. When the government is too intrusive, it makes life no longer worth living, and the people lose their love of life and their fear of death.
--	--	--	---	--

	Those who are so eager to make a better living that they risk death in doing so are the very ones most likely to die. Only the self-sufficient person who depends upon and endangers no one else in order to get his living is most sure to live. up	kept under control People want to die Because they don't want to live this way Therefore people want to die Only the one who is not afraid to live, Is not afraid of dying up		To promote the value of life, do not interfere with it. up
--	---	--	--	---

Chapter 76

At birth a man is soft and weak - yet capable of living the whole life ahead of him. At death he is hard and tough - yet unable to live for even a minute longer. All things, whether plants of animals, while living, are soft and weak, But, when dead, are hard and tough.

When a human being is born, it's supple and weak When it dies it's stiff and strong Everything that's alive (take a look at grass and trees for example) Is supple and flexible And when they die they are shriveled and parched Therefore hardness

A WARNING AGAINST RIGIDITY At the birth of man, he is elastic and weak; at his death, rigid and unyielding. This is the common law; trees also, in their youth, are tender and supple; in their decay, hard and dry.

People are born soft and flexible; when they are dead, they are hard and stiff. Living plants are tender and pliant; when they are dead, they are brittle and dried out. Therefore, whatever is hard and stiff is a sign of death.

Thus hardness and toughness are allied with death, While softness and weakness are interrelated with life. This is the reason why the tougher fighters are more likely to be killed, and the harder trees more likely to be cut down. Therefore it is better to be soft and weak than to be hard and tough. up

and inflexibility are companions of death And suppleness and softness, companions of life That's why a rigid troublemaker will never win And an inflexible tree is doomed to death Inflexibility and power won't get you very far Suppleness and softness get you everywhere up

So then rigidity and hardness are the stigmata of death; elasticity and adaptability, of life. He then who putteth forth strength is not victorious; even as a strong tree filleth the embrace. Thus the hard and rigid have the inferior place, the soft and elastic the superior.

Whatever is soft and flexible is a sign of life. An army without flexibility never wins. An unbending tree is easily brought down by the wind. The hard and stiff fall. The soft and flexible rise. up

Chapter 77

Nature's way is like the bending of a bow: The top which is high is lowered while the bottom which is low is raised, And the width which is narrow is widened while the length which is long is shortened. Nature's way is to take from those that have too much and give to those that have too little.

The natural order is like stretching a bow The low bow gets pushed up high And the high tendon pulled downwards Where there is too much, it takes away Where there is not enough, it fills Nature strives for harmony all the time Decreases where there is too much And increases where there is too little But how opposite are the people

THE WAY OF HEAVEN The Tao of Heaven is likened to the bending of a bow, whereby the high part is brought down, and the low part raised up. The extreme is diminished, and the middle increased. This is the Way of Heaven, to remove excess, and to supplement insufficiency.

The Tao is like the bending of a bow. The top is bent downward; the bottom is bent up. If the cord is too long, it is shortened; if it is too short, it is lengthened. The policy of the Tao is to take from those who have too much and give to those who have too little. But that is not the human practice.

in their behaviour The poor get poorer while the rich tend to get richer But one who is wise realizes that possession is burglary to community Therefore he disposes himself of that which belongs to the community So only one who is wise is detached He does what others ask him to, but nothing for himself Without taking credit for it up

Not so is the way of man, who taketh away from him that hath not to give to him that hath already excess. Who can employ his own excess to the weal of all under Heaven? Only he that possesseth the Tao. So the Wise Man acteth without lust of result; achieveth and boasteth not; he willeth not to proclaim his greatness.

We take from those who have too little and give to those who have too much. Who is it that has more than enough and gives his surplus to those in need? Only the follower of the Tao. The follower of the Tao acts without hope of gain, accomplishes but takes no credit, does not wish to lord it over others. up

Chapter 78

. The Soft and Weak Nothing in the world is softer and weaker than water. Yet nothing is better at attacking the hard and strong. There is no substitute for it. The weak overcomes the strong; the soft overcomes the hard.

Nothing is weaker than water; Yet, for attacking what is hard and tough, Nothing surpasses it, nothing equals it. The principle, that what is weak overcomes what is strong, And what is yielding conquers what is resistant, Is known to everybody. Yet few men utilize it profitably in practice.

Nothing in life is so soft and compliant as water Nothing is stronger in breaking what is hard and strong Nothing can exceed it in doing this Weak overcomes strong Soft overcomes hard Nobody knows this And no one

A CREED Nothing in the world is more elastic and yielding than water; yet it is preeminent to dissolve things rigid and resistant; there is nothing which can match it. All men know that the soft overcometh the hard, and the weak conquereth the strong; but none are able to use this law in action.

Water is soft and yielding, but nothing can more effectively dissolve the hard and inflexible. Weak defeats strong. Soft defeats hard. This is well known, but not easy to put into practice.

Everyone knows this, but no one puts it into practice. Therefore the wise say, "Those who bear the humiliation of the people are able to minister to them. Those who take upon themselves the sins of the society are able to lead the world." Words of truth seem paradoxical. up

But the intelligent man knows that: He who willingly takes the blame for disgrace to his community is considered a responsible person, And he who submissively accepts responsibility for the evils in his community naturally will be given enough authority for dealing with them. These principles, no matter how paradoxical, are sound. up

practices it Therefore the sage says: One who is the least in the world, will be the greatest in life One who carries the sorrow of the world, is the greatest among mankind It sounds odd, but it's true up

A Wise Man hath said: 'He that taketh on the burden of the state is a demigod worthy of sacrificial worship; and the true King of a people is he that undertaketh the weight of their sorrows.' Truth appeareth paradox.

Therefore, the Tao Master says: He who takes upon himself the dirt of the nation becomes the master of its sacred soil; he who takes upon himself the evils of the land becomes a true king under Heaven. Straight words seem crooked. up

Chapter 79

. Stay with the Good Compromising with great hatred surely leaves some hatred. How can this be considered good? Therefore the wise keep their part of an agreement and do not blame the other party.	Make agreements and then quarrelling when they are broken is never advisable. For even when a quarrel is patched up, some animosity will remain. How can this be considered good?	When people make peace after violent hostility Then it's an armed peace How can it be right?	TRUTH IN COVENANT When enemies are reconciled, there is always an aftermath of illwill. How can this be useful? Therefore, the Wise Man, while he keepeth his part of the record of a transaction, doth not insist on its prompt execution.	Great resentment, even when appeased, does not go away. How can this be good? Therefore, the Tao■Master keeps his promises, but he does not look into whether others are keeping theirs.
The good fulfill their obligations; the bad exact obligations from others. The Way of heaven is impartial. It always stays with the good. up	Therefore the intelligent man continues to carry out his side of a bargain Even though he does not demand of others that they fulfill their promises The righteous insist on keeping agreements to the letter, And the indiscreet foolishly neglect or break their agreements; But Nature neither keeps nor breaks contracts (because it makes none). And its ways are good for men. up	One who is wise only takes a look at his own share in the conflict And never blames his opponent So one who is fair only faces his own part While one who is not daring enough to look at oneself, blames the other The road to self-knowledge knows no partiality But it does benefit the sincere up	He who hath the Teh considereth the situation from all sides, while he who hath it not seeketh only to benefit himself. In the Tao of Heaven, there is no distinction of persons in its love; but it is for the True Man to claim it.	The man of virtue (Te) monitors himself; The man without virtue monitors others. The Tao of Heaven plays no favorites, but it is always manifest in the good man. up

Chapter 80

. Home Is Comfortable In a small country with few people machines that can work ten or a hundred times faster are not needed. People who care about death do not travel far. Even if there are ships and carriages, no one takes them.

The ideal state is a small intimate community Where all the necessities of life are present in abundance. There everyone is satisfied to live and die without looking around for greener pastures. Even if they have cars or boats, they do not use them for travelling abroad. Even if they have police and fortifications, these are never put to use.

May mankind live in freedom, equality and brotherhood again, So that there will be no need for leaders and superiors Then people won't fear death any longer And won't try to escape death May it be that people don't feel the need anymore, To move themselves about in vehicles And that they will have nothing to defend anymore May humankind abandon their instruments and machines, And

ISOLATION In a little kingdom of few people it should be the order that though there were men able to do the work of ten men or five score, they should not be employed. Though the people regarded death as sorrowful, yet they should not wish to go elsewhere. They should have boats and wagons, yet no necessity to travel; corslets and weapons, yet no occasion to fight.

Imagine a small country with a small population. They have lots of technology, but they use none of it. They take the prospect of death seriously and thus do not travel far from home. They have boats and carriages, but no one takes them out. They have weapons and armor, but no one takes them out of the armory. Instead of writing, they have gone back to the old system of cord■knotting.

Even if there are armor and weapons, no one displays them. People return to knotted rope for records. Food is tasty; clothes are beautiful; home is comfortable; customs are delightful. Though neighboring communities see each other and hear each other's cocks crowing and dogs barking, they may grow old and die without going there. up

enjoy the seeds of the fruit-bearing plants Those were meant as our food May they feel shamelessly proud of their natural beauty again May they stop locking themselves away in cities and houses, And start enjoying creation And if some fools still lock themselves away in nations, Civilizations, cities and houses May the wise men keep themselves far from this, And live happily ever after up

For communication they should use knotted cords. They should deem their food sweet, their clothes beautiful, their houses homes, their customs delightful. There should be another state within view, so that its fowls and dogs should be heard; yet to old age, even to death, the people should hold no traffic with it.

They enjoy their plain but good food, their simple but fine clothing, their humble but secure homes. They are happy with their way of life. The next country is so close that the crowing of the cocks and the barking of the dogs over there can be easily heard over here; and yet the people over here grow old and die without ever having been over there. up

Chapter 81

. True Words
True words are not beautiful.
Beautiful words are not truthful.
The good do not argue. Those who argue are not good. Those who know are not scholarly. The scholarly do not know.

He who is genuine is not artificial; He who is artificial is not genuine. He who is intelligent is not quarrelsome; He who is quarrelsome is not intelligent. He who is wise is not pretentious; He who is pretentious is not wise. Therefore the intelligent man does not struggle to achieve for himself.

True words are not pretty
Pretty words are not true
Wise men do not talk about the Unspeakable
One who talks about the Unspeakable is not wise
Wise men are not learned
And learned ones aren't wise
A wise man

THE SHEWING-FORTH OF SIMPLICITY
True speech is not elegant; elaborate speech is not truth.
Those who know do not argue; the argumentative are without knowledge.
Those who have assimilated are not learned; those who are gross with learning have not assimilated.

True words aren't pretty; pretty words aren't true.
The good do not contend; those who contend aren't good. The wise are not learned; the learned are not wise. The Tao■Master is not greedy.

The wise do not hoard. The more they give to others, the more they have. The Way of heaven sharpens but does no harm. The Way of the wise accomplishes without striving.
© Sanderson Beck, 1996

The more useful he is to others, the more his needs will be cared for by those repeatedly benefited by his yielding. Nature's way is to produce good without evil. The intelligent man's way is to accept and follow Nature rather than to oppose Nature.

doesn't gather possessions
He gives what he has
And therefore he is worthy of living
He shares his wisdom with others
His wisdom is never-ending
Living according to nature never harms
The life of a wise man is unselfish and peaceful

The Wise Man doth not hoard.
The more he giveth, the more he hath; the more he watereth, the more is he watered himself.
The Tao of Heaven is like an Arrow, yet it woundeth not; and the Wise Man, in all his Works, maketh no contention.

The more he does for others, the more he has. The more he gives to others, the richer he becomes. The Tao sharpens without cutting. The Tao■Master acts with non■ado. [no frames]